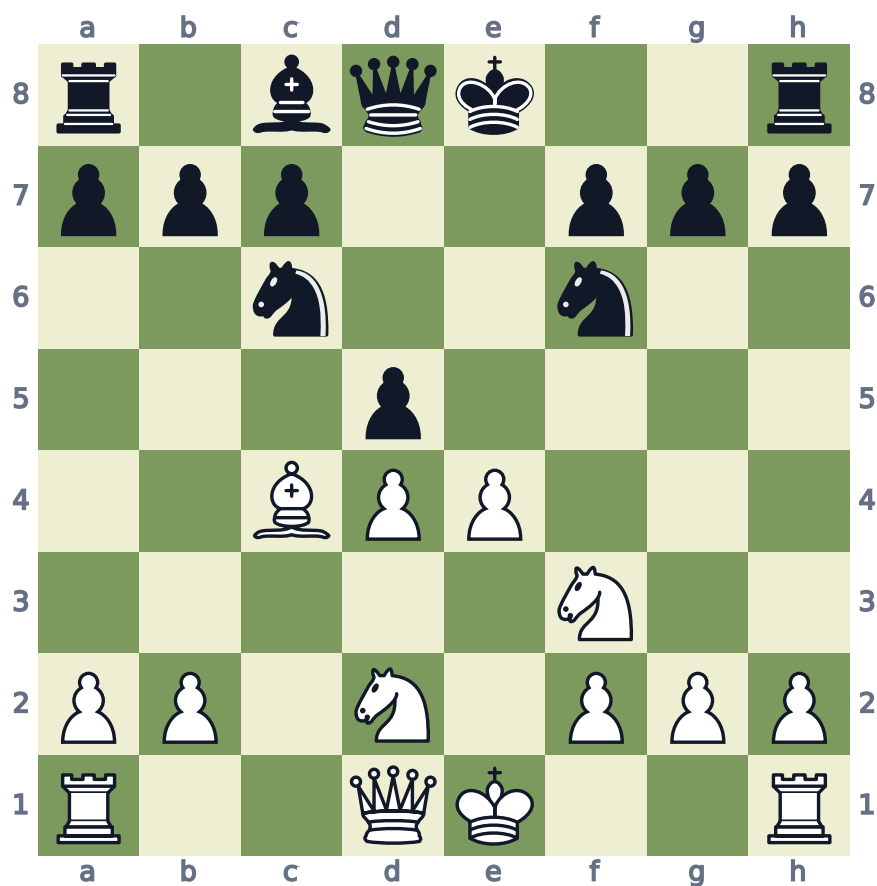


Player-Style Collections

Attacking, positional, defensive, technical, and universal chess



Explore five sound ways of solving chess problems, identify the positions each style handles well, and avoid confusing style with an excuse to ignore the position.

30 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Explore five sound ways of solving chess problems, identify the positions each style handles well, and avoid confusing style with an excuse to ignore the position.

TRAINING RULES

- Style chooses among sound options; it cannot make an unsound move correct.
- Solve each position once with the named style, then once as a universal player.
- Notice which positions feel natural and which expose a blind spot.
- Train the least comfortable sound style regularly so preference does not become limitation.
-

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 30 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

SCORING

What a complete answer contains

RECOGNITION

Name the tactical or strategic feature without assuming that the familiar pattern works.

CANDIDATES

List serious forcing and improving choices before analyzing deeply.

BEST RESISTANCE

Calculate the opponent's least cooperative legal response.

ENDPOINT

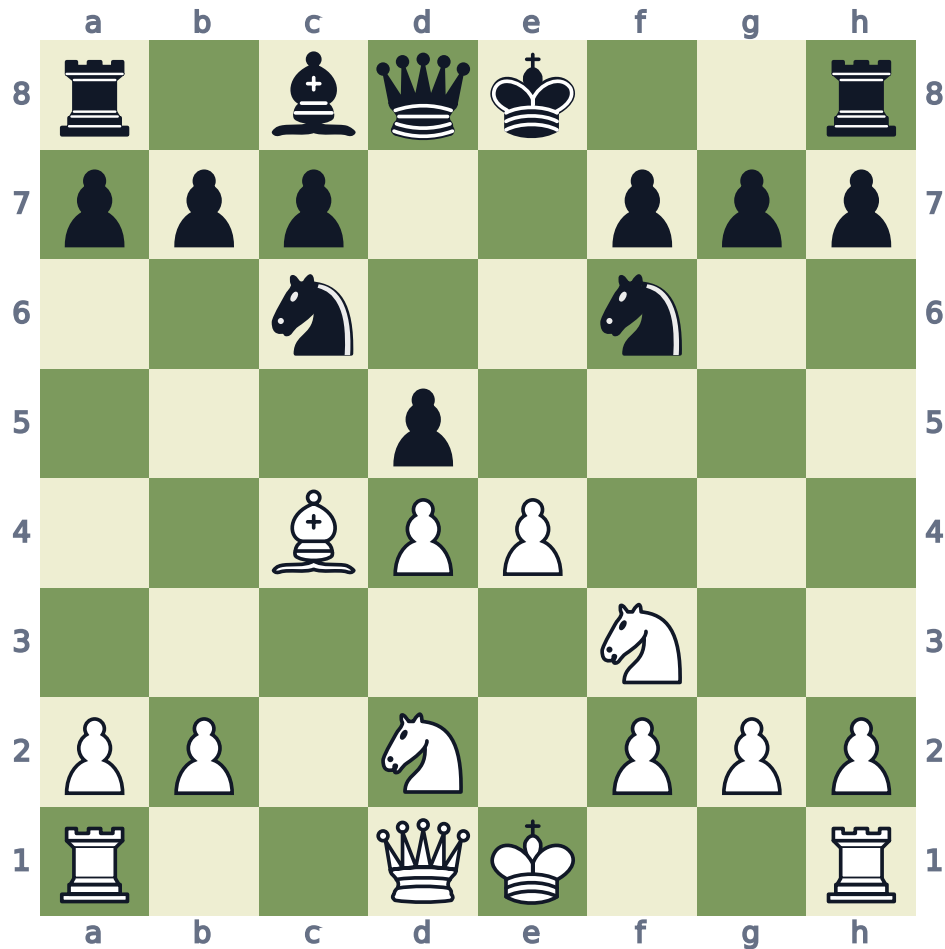
Stop only after forcing play settles, then evaluate material, kings, activity, and structure.

TRANSFER

State the visible cue that should make you remember this position during a game.

PROBLEM 01 OF 30

Attacking style: Italian Game



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

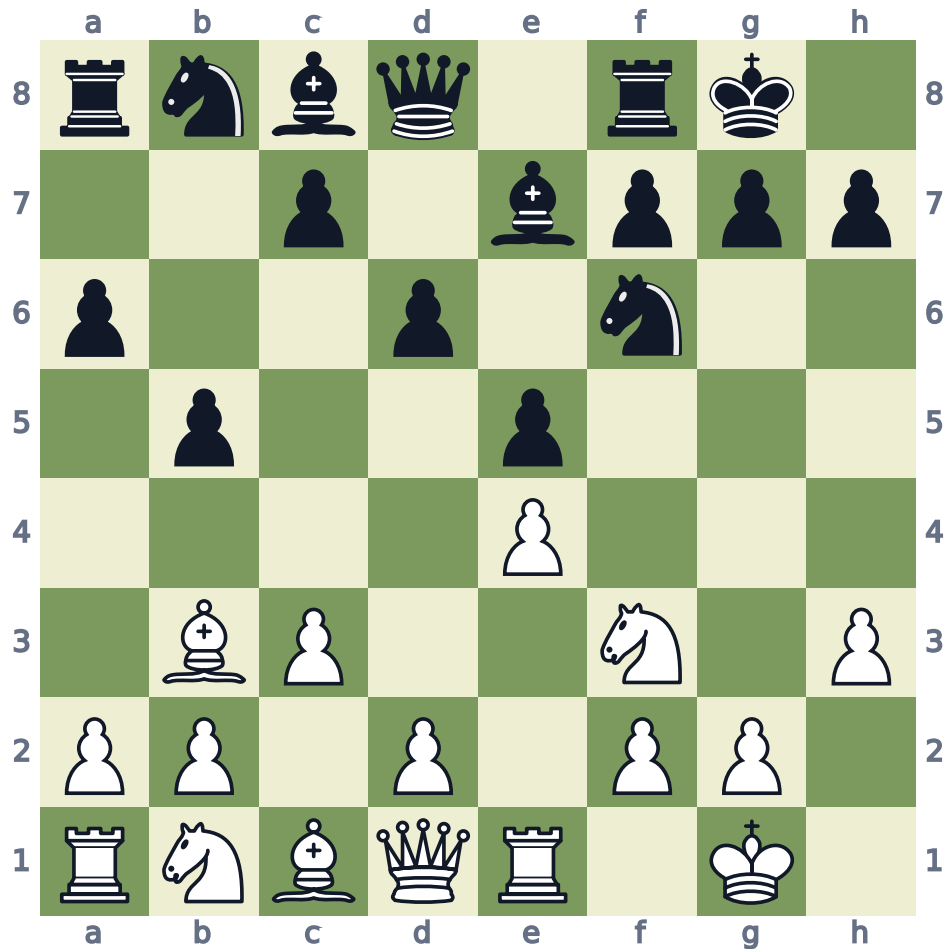
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 02 OF 30

Attacking style: Ruy Lopez



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

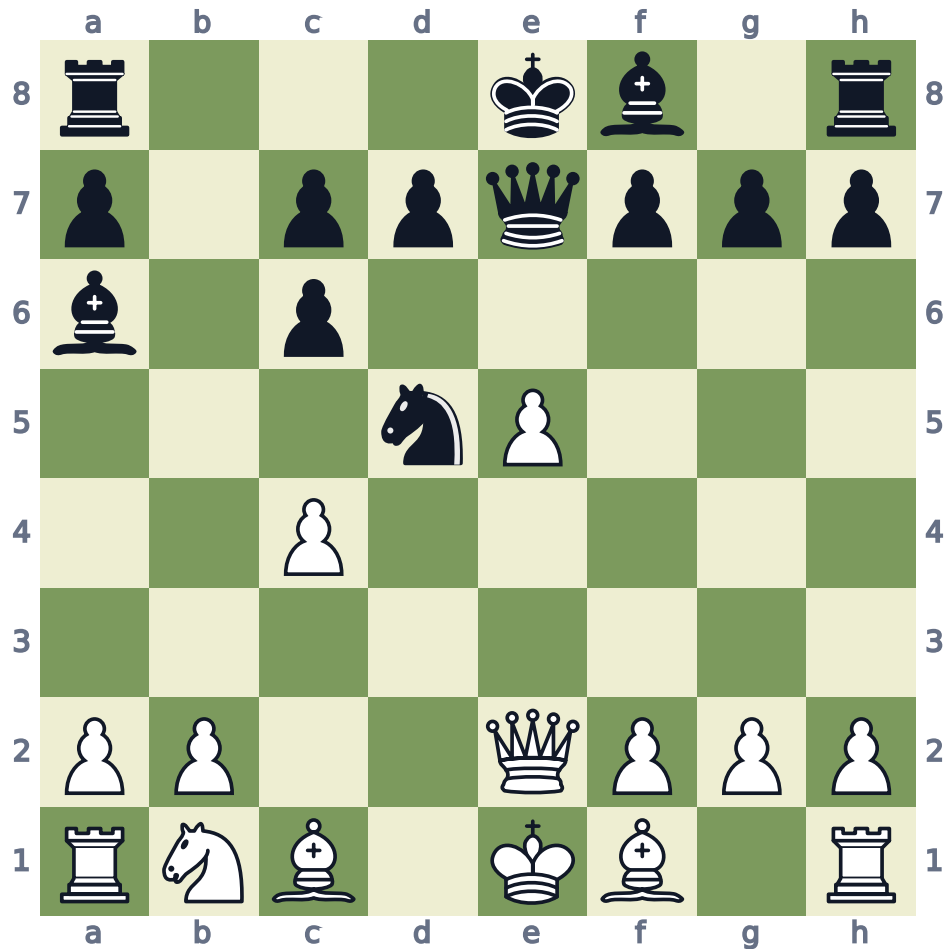
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 03 OF 30

Attacking style: Scotch Game



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

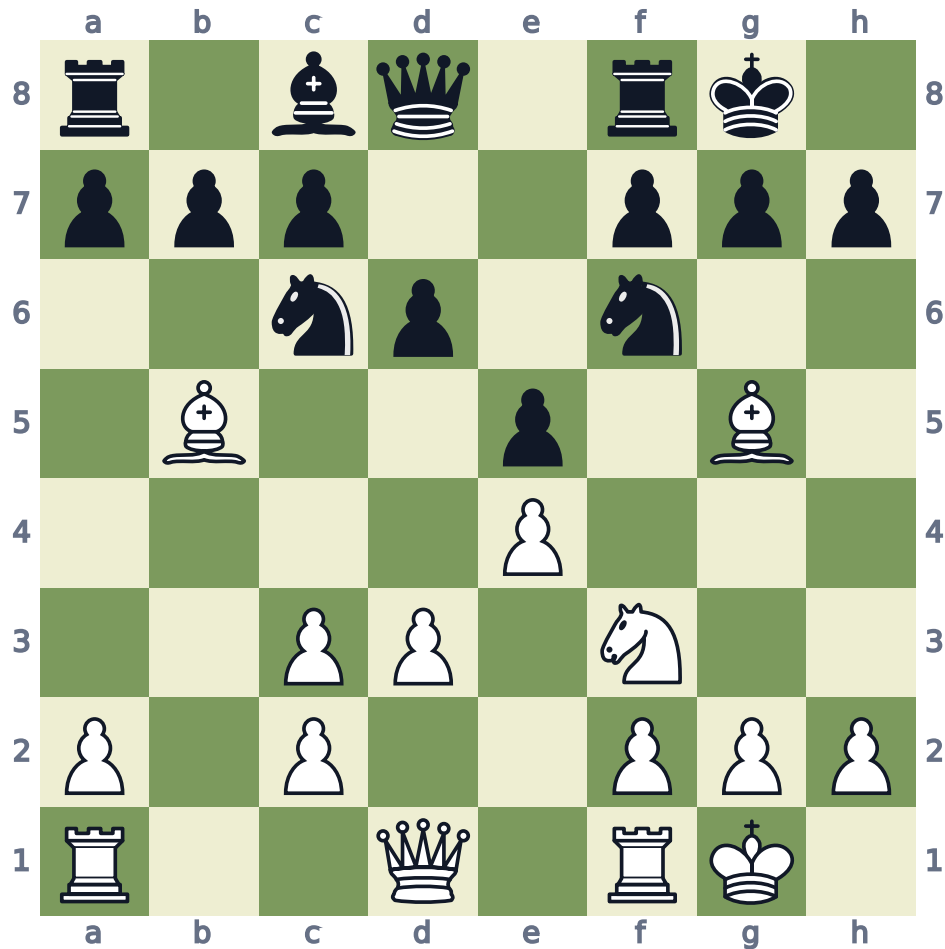
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 04 OF 30

Attacking style: Four Knights Game



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

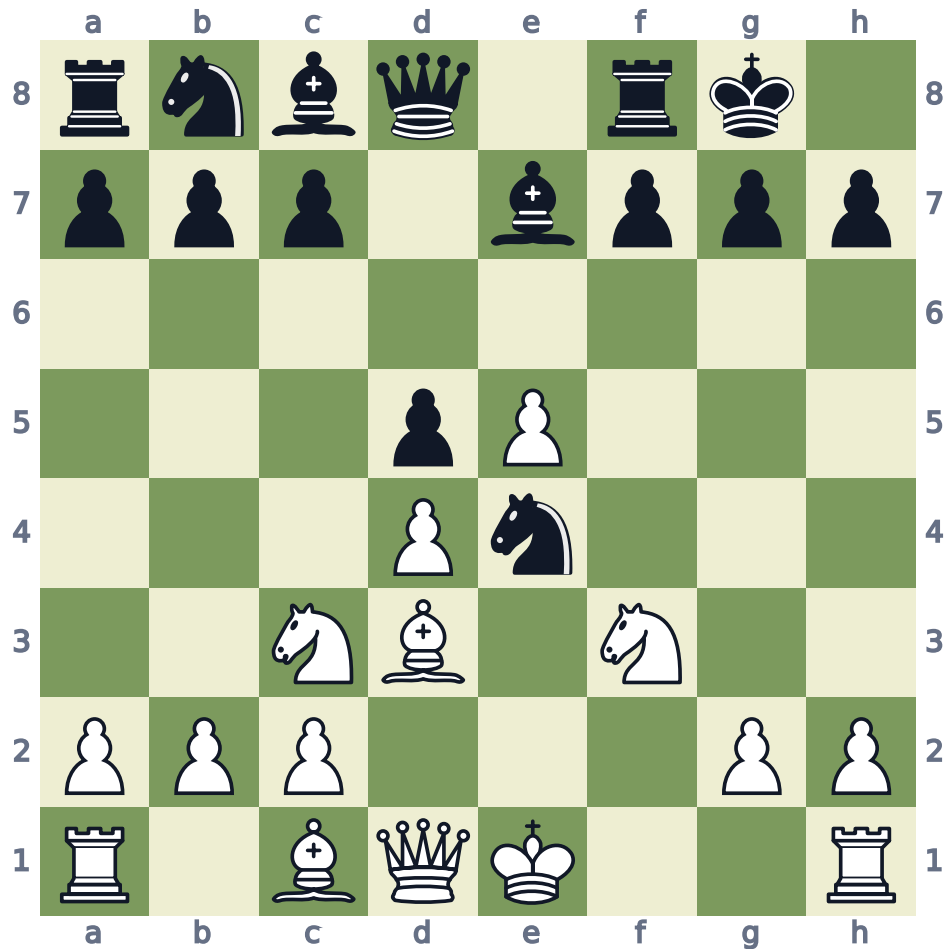
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 05 OF 30

Attacking style: Vienna Game



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

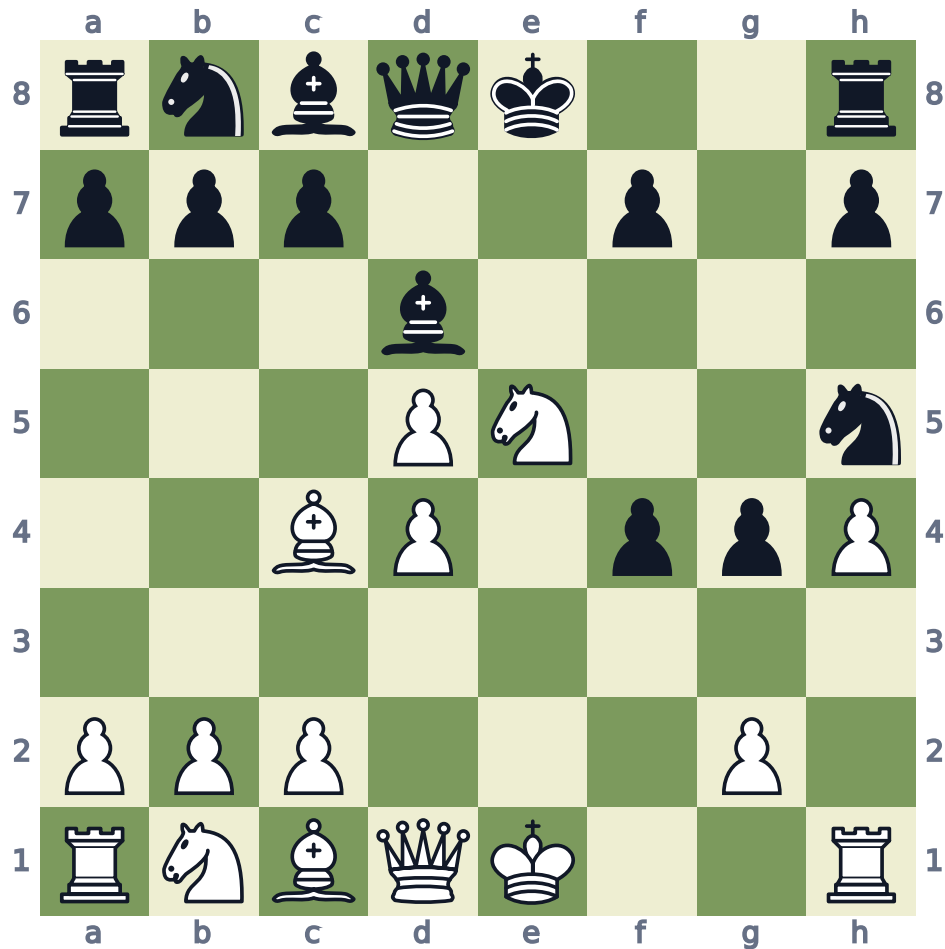
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 06 OF 30

Attacking style: King's Gambit



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through an attacking lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

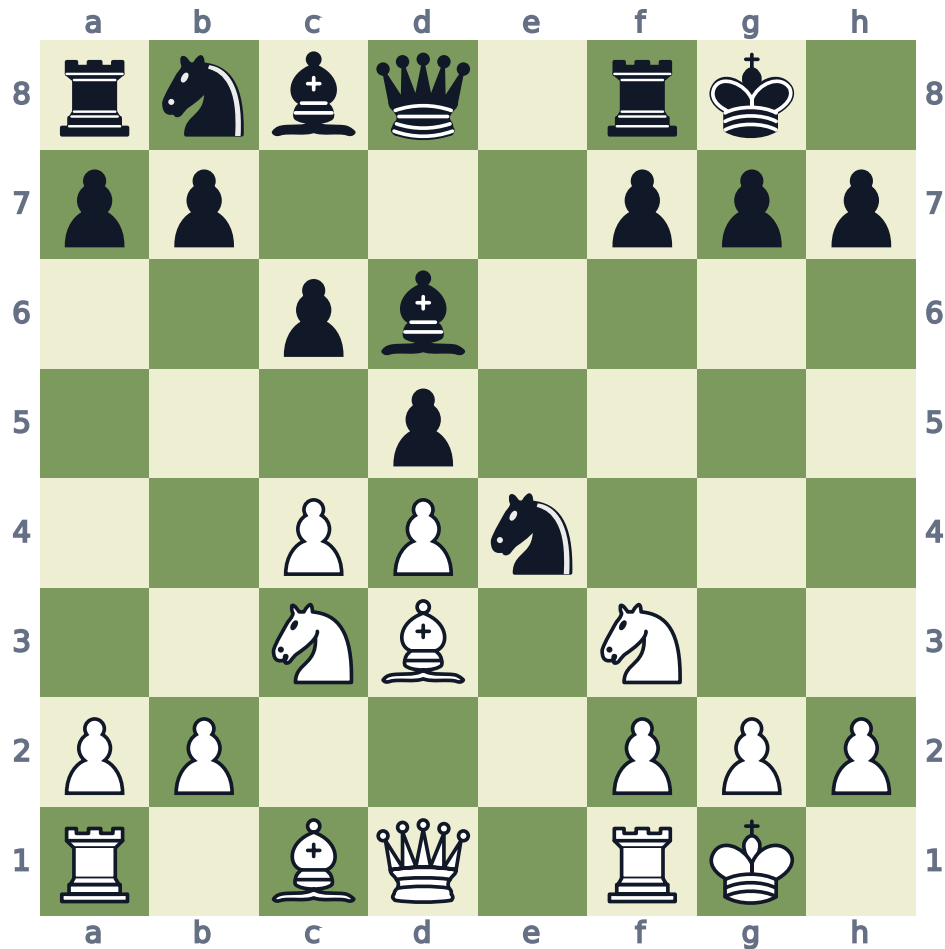
Attacking decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 07 OF 30

Positional style: Petrov Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

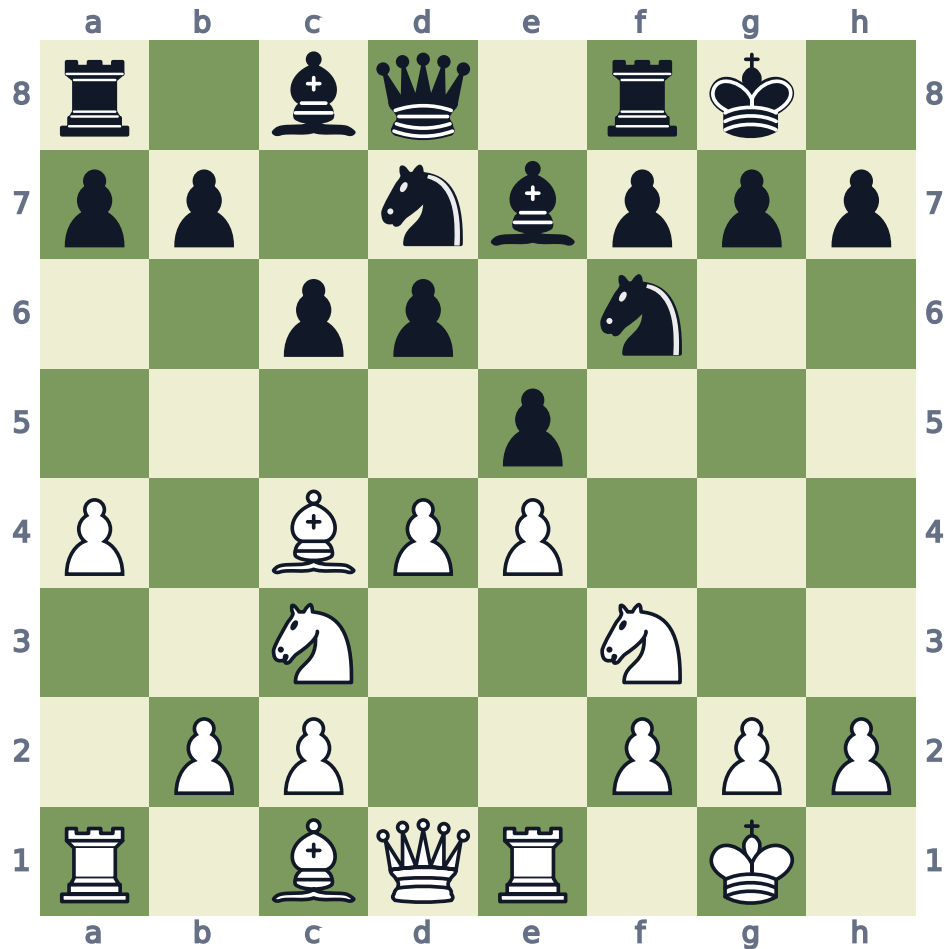
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 08 OF 30

Positional style: Philidor Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

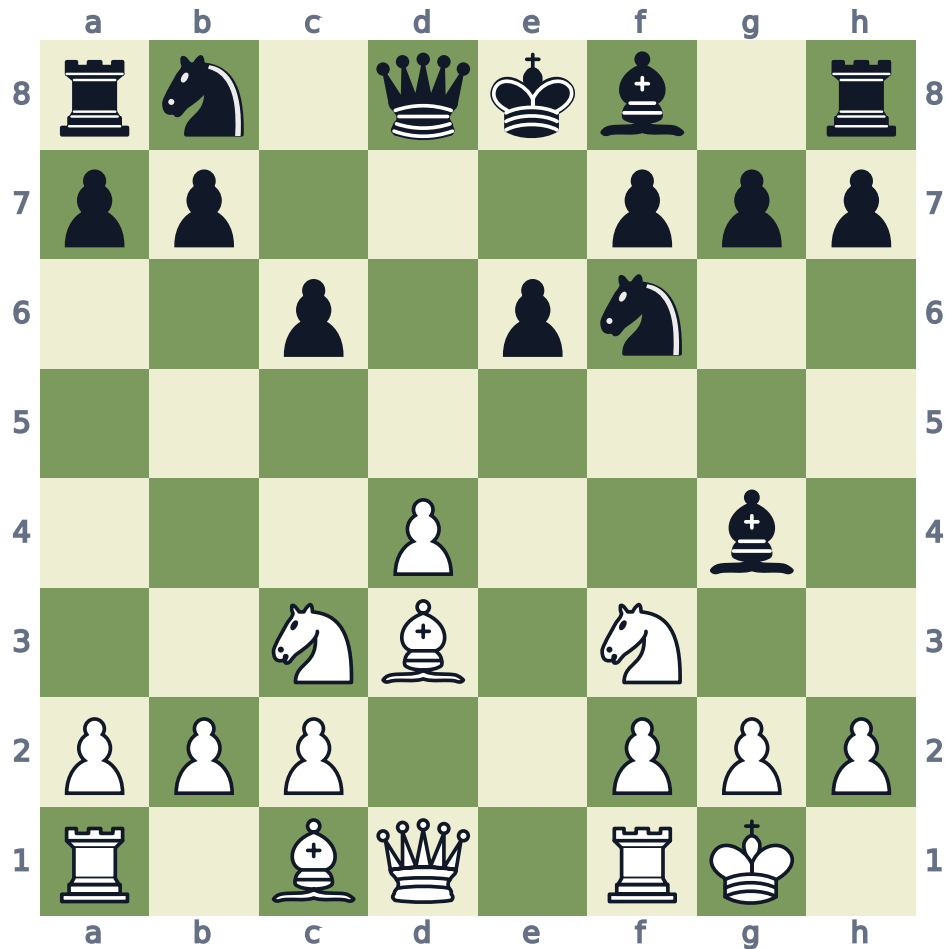
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 09 OF 30

Positional style: Scandinavian Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

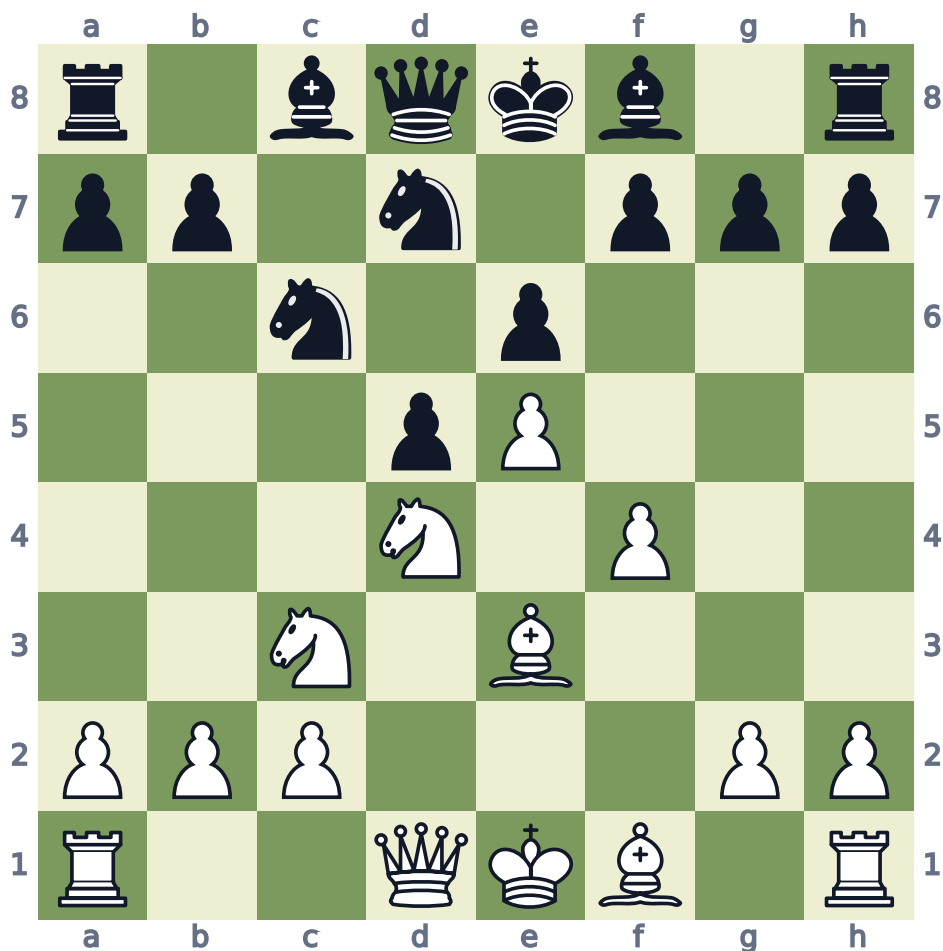
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 10 OF 30

Positional style: French Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

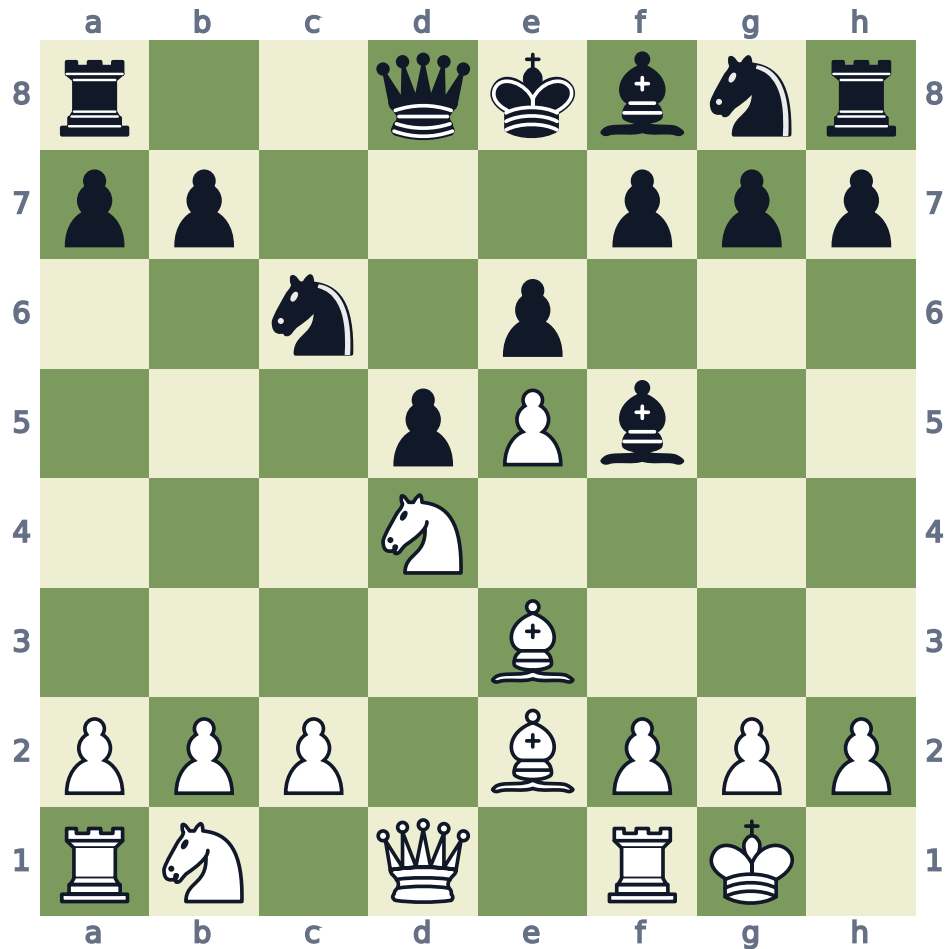
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 11 OF 30

Positional style: Caro-Kann Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

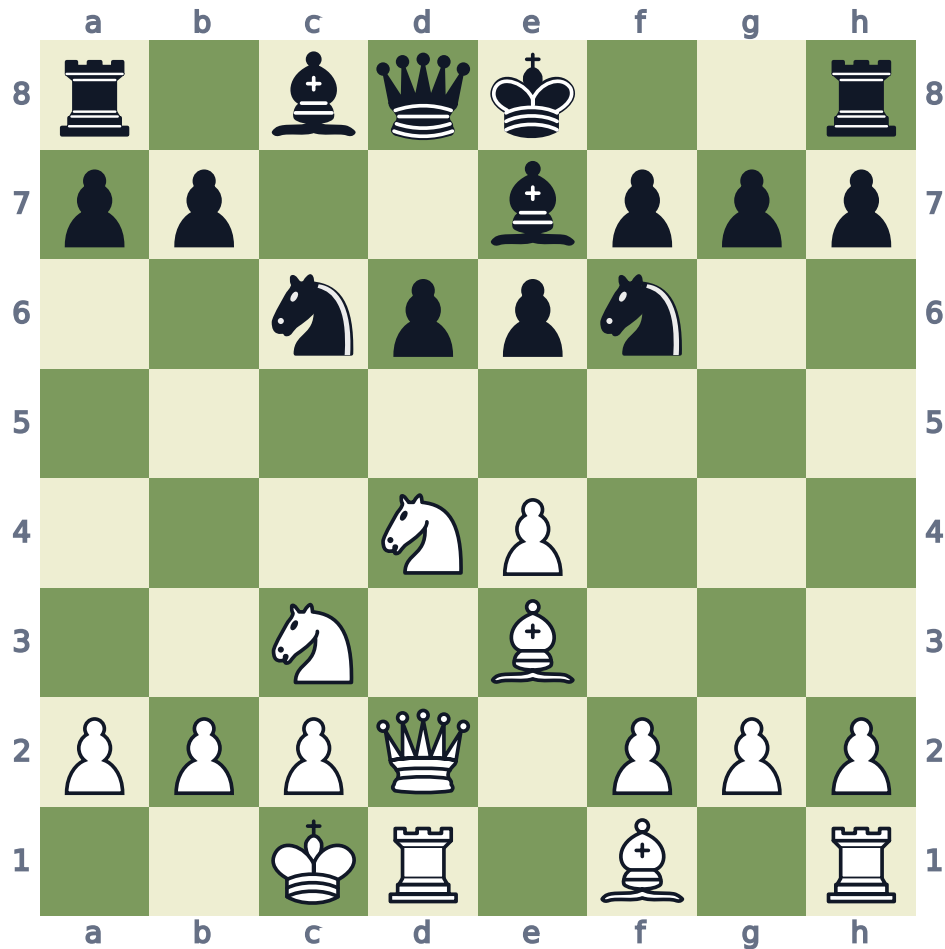
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 12 OF 30

Positional style: Open Sicilian



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a positional lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

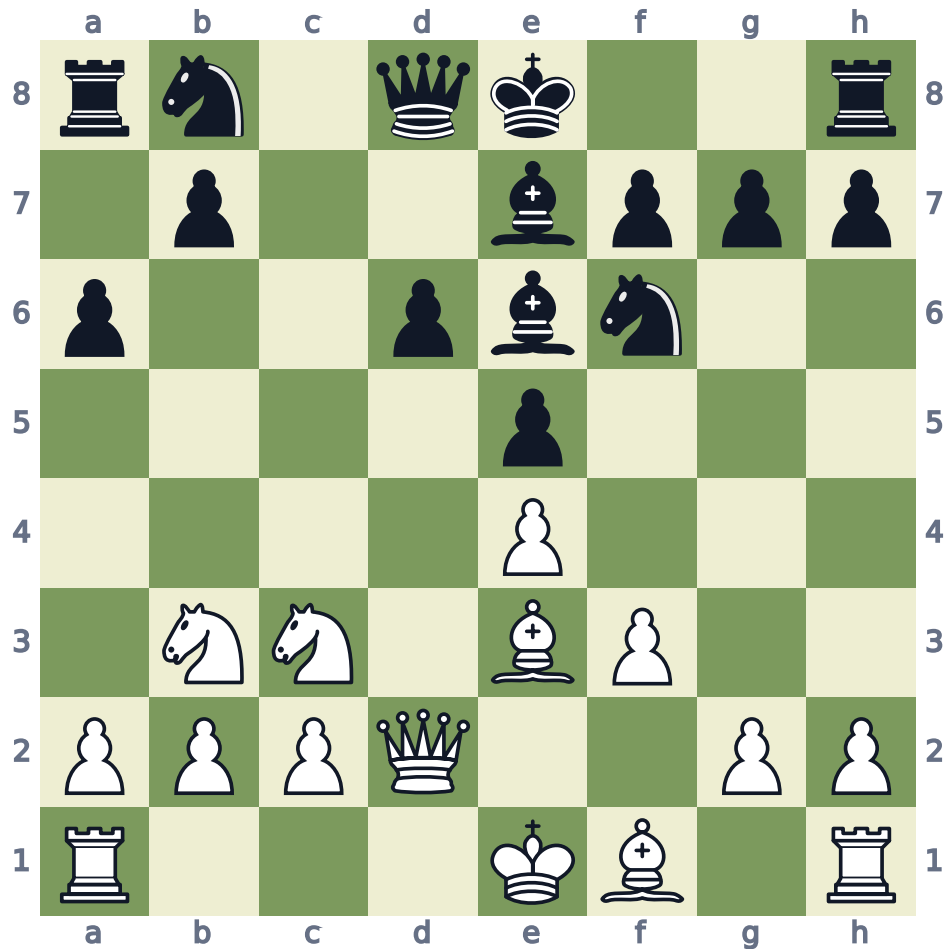
Positional decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 13 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Najdorf



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

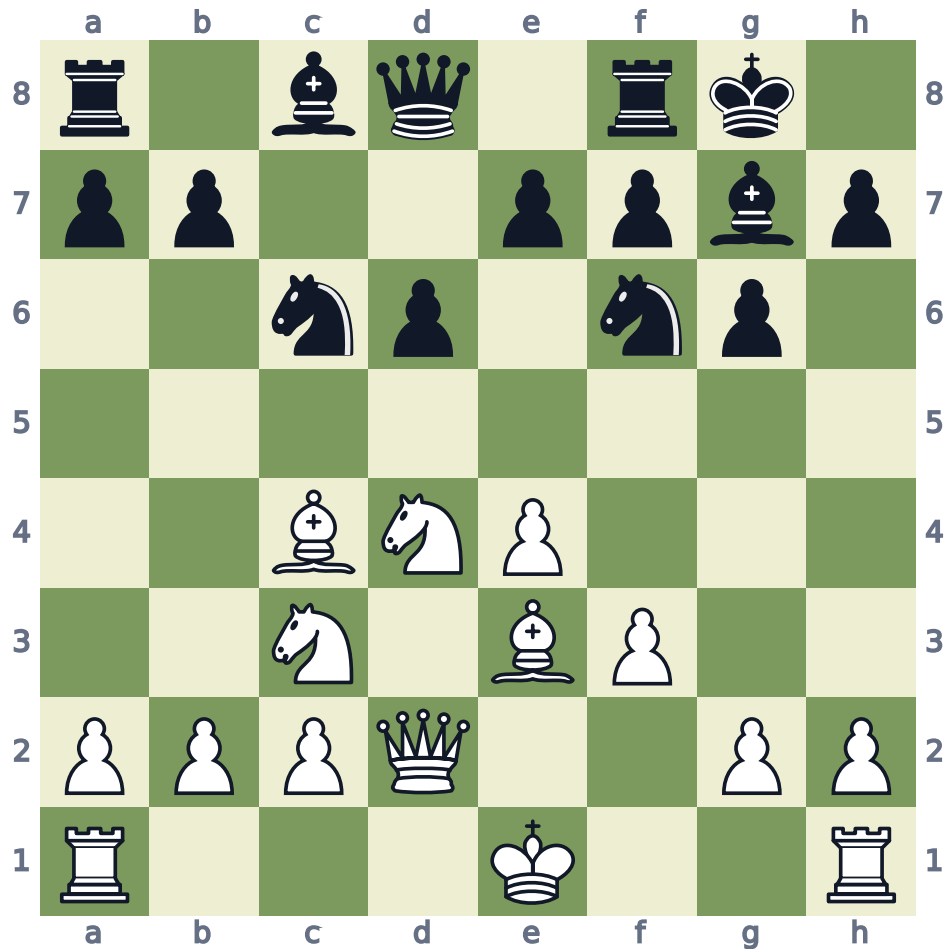
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 14 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Dragon



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

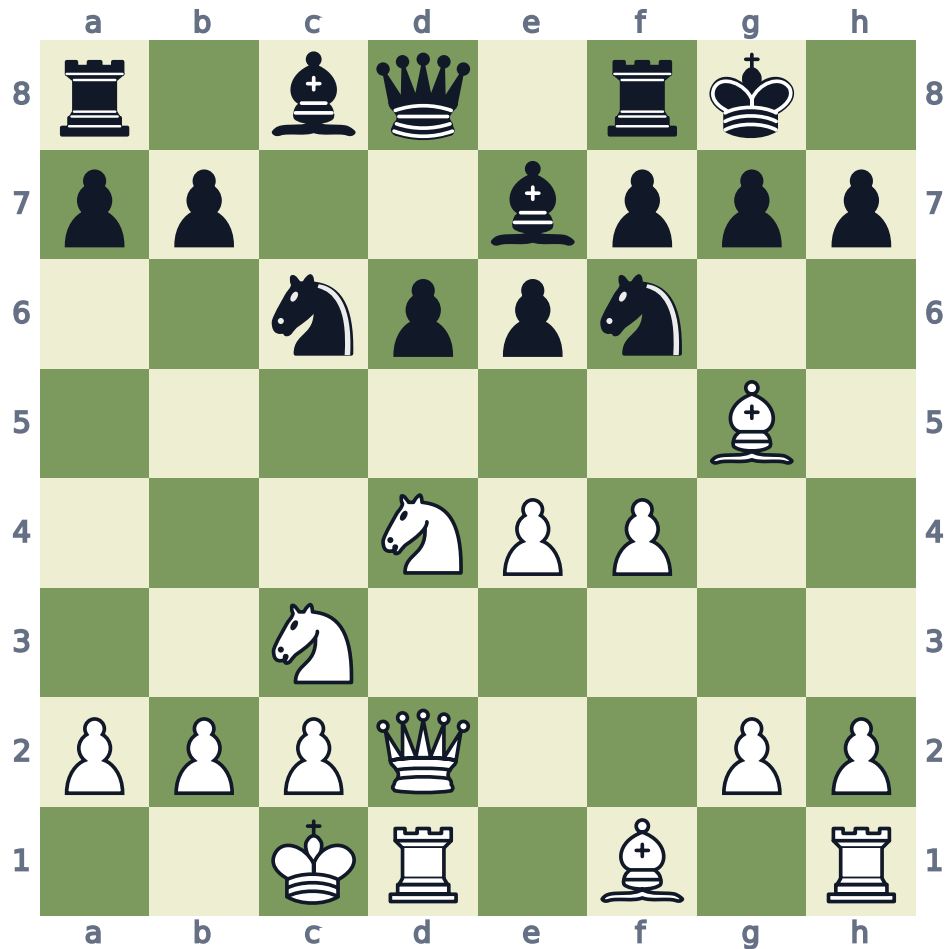
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 15 OF 30

Defensive style: Classical Sicilian



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

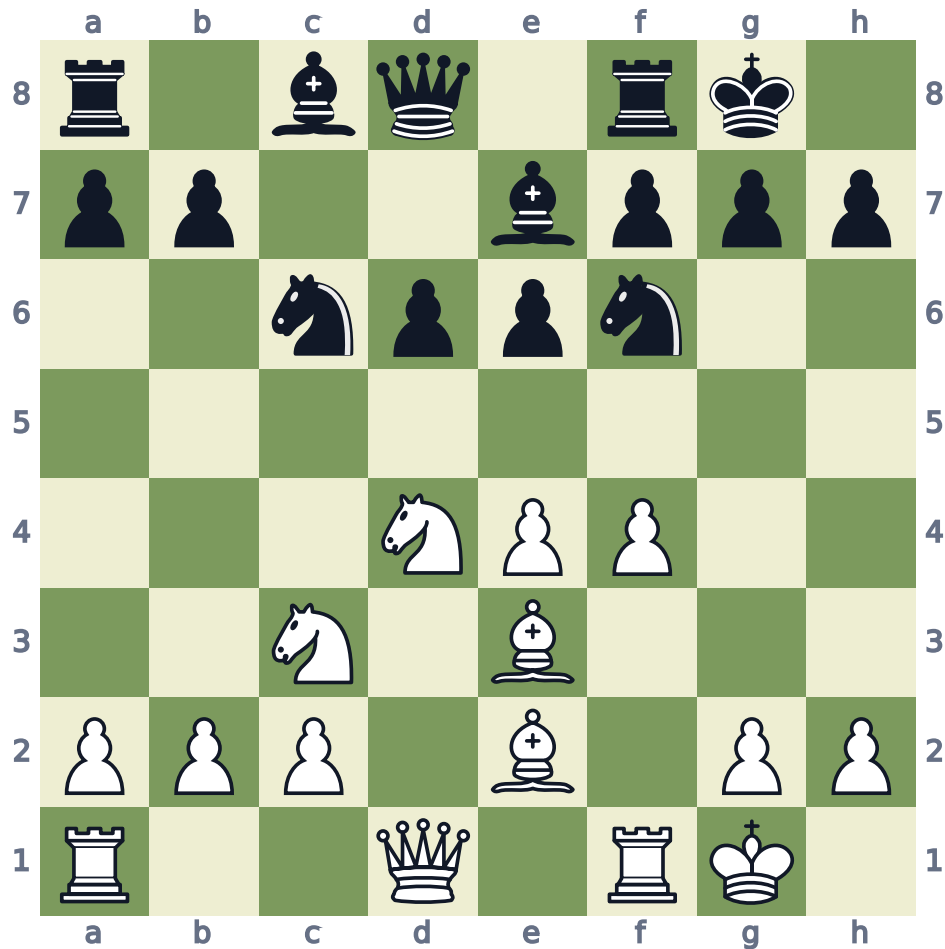
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 16 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Scheveningen



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

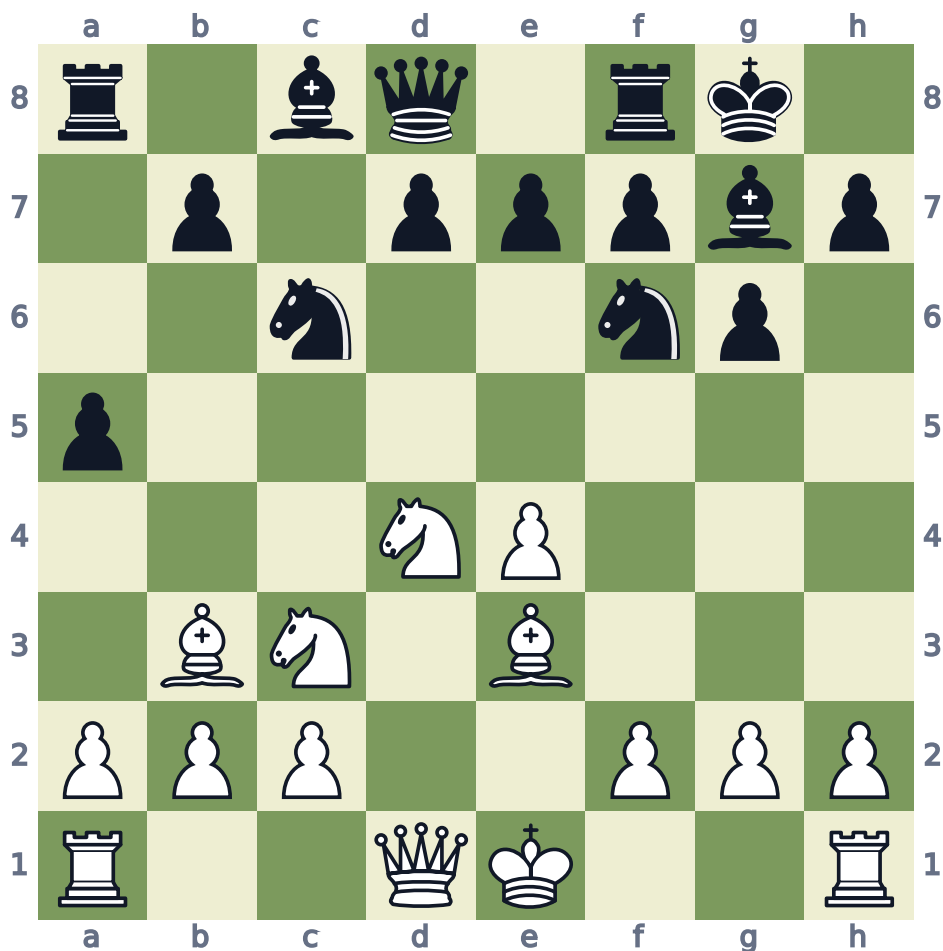
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 17 OF 30

Defensive style: Accelerated Dragon



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

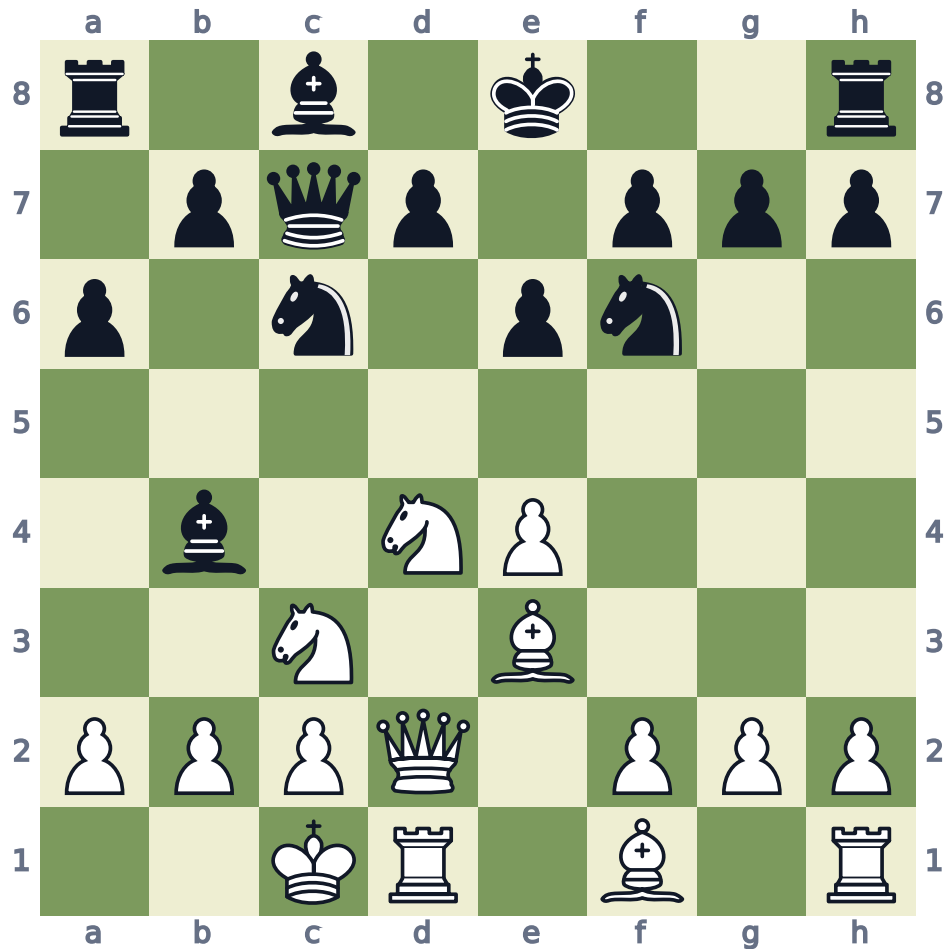
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 18 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Taimanov



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a defensive lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

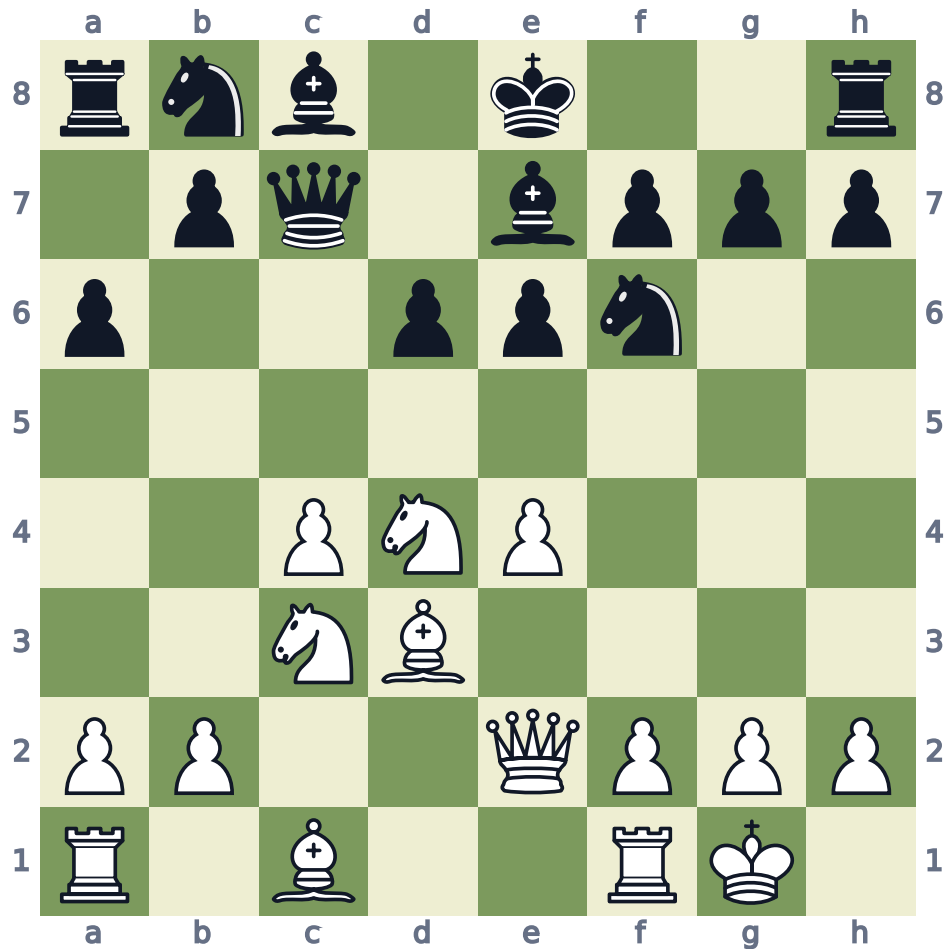
Defensive decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 19 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Kan



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

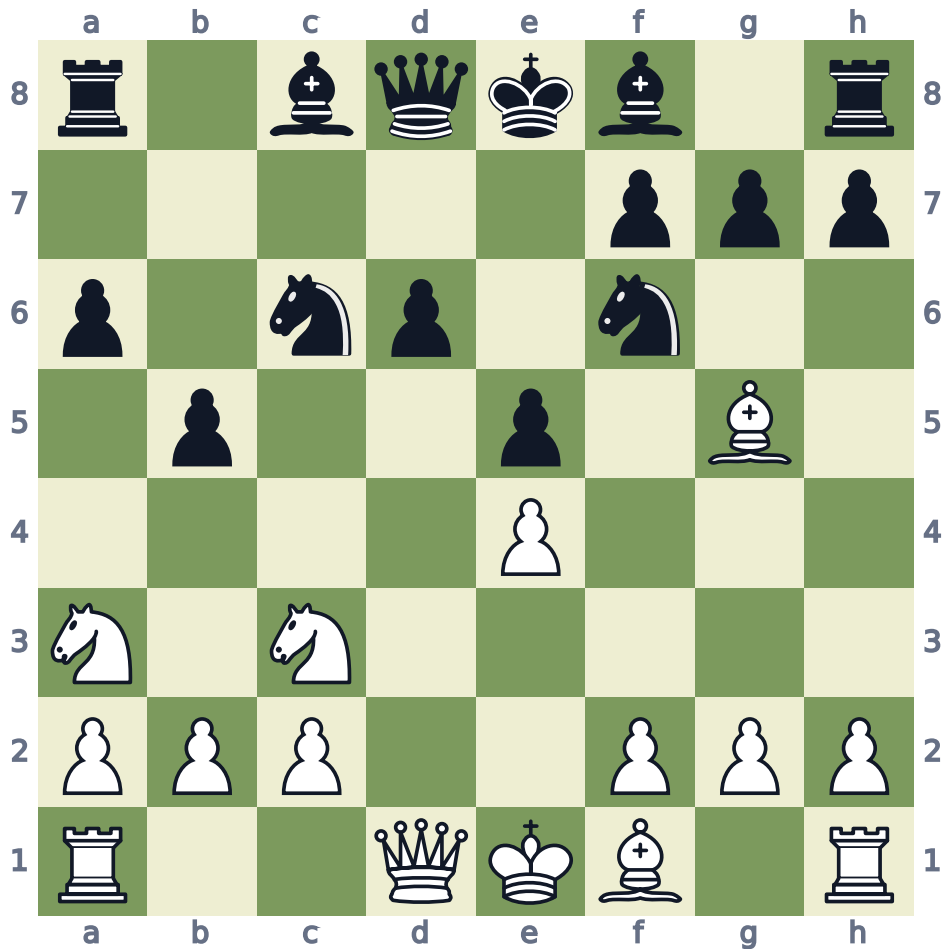
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 20 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Sveshnikov



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

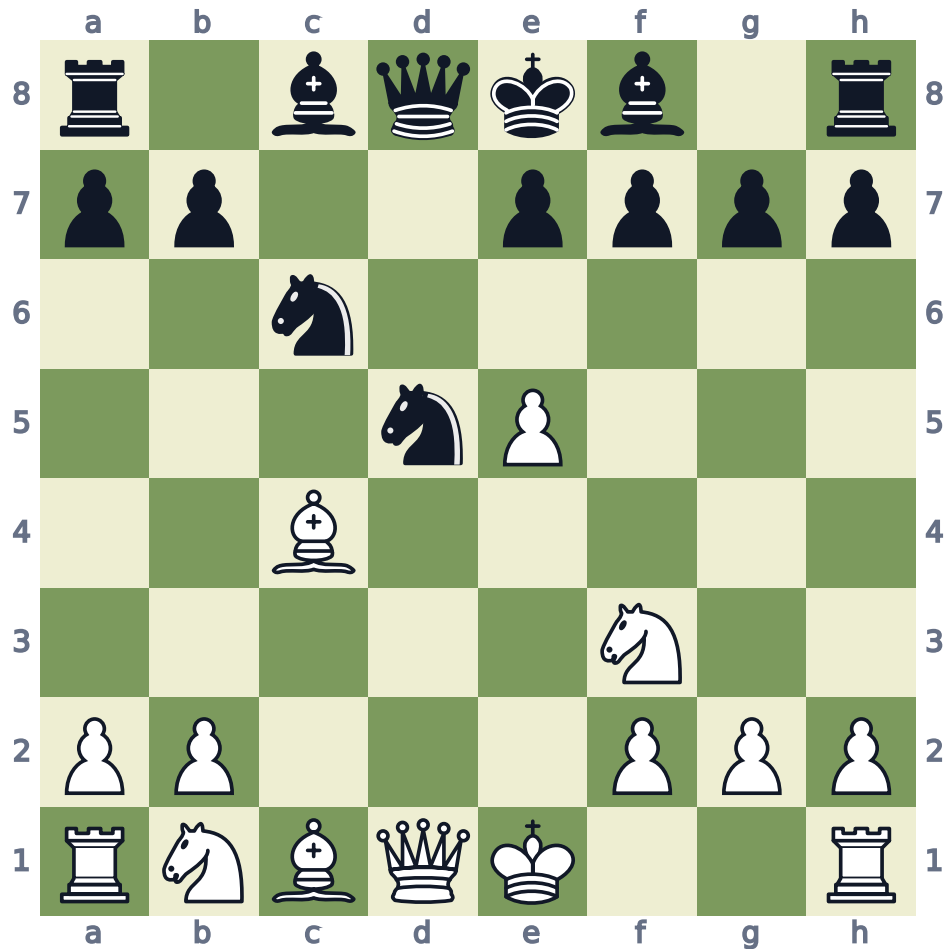
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 21 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Alapin



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

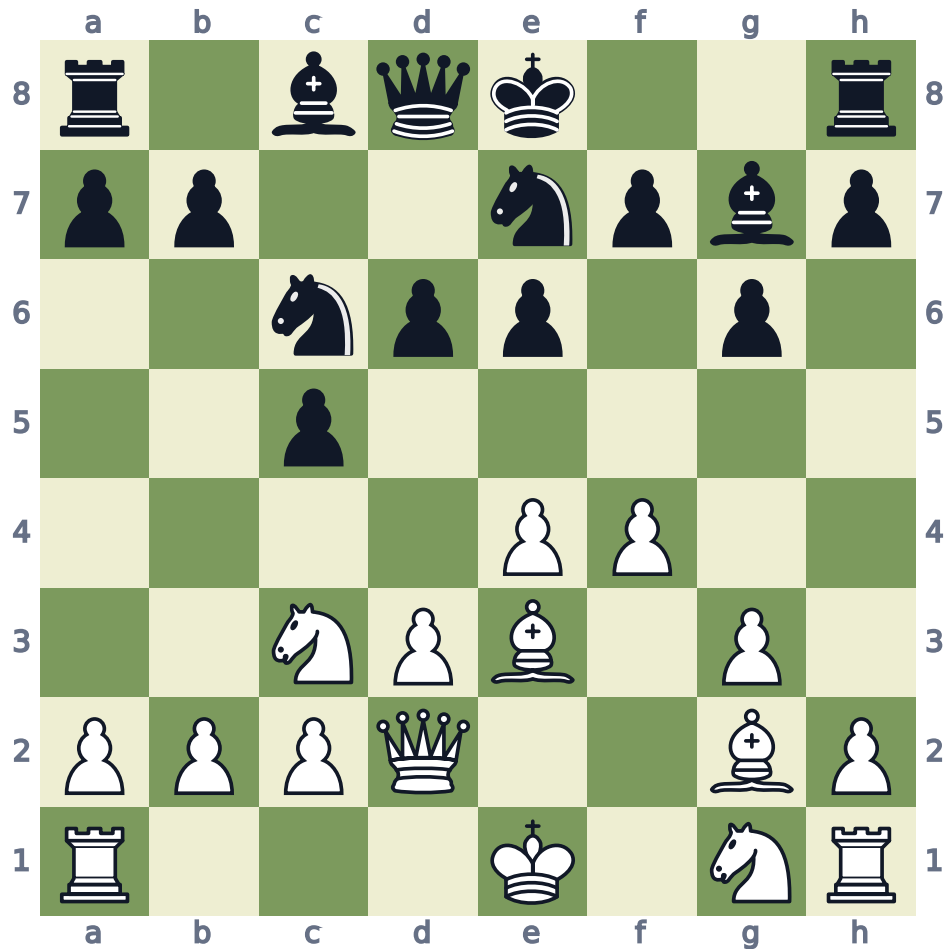
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 22 OF 30

Technical style: Closed Sicilian



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

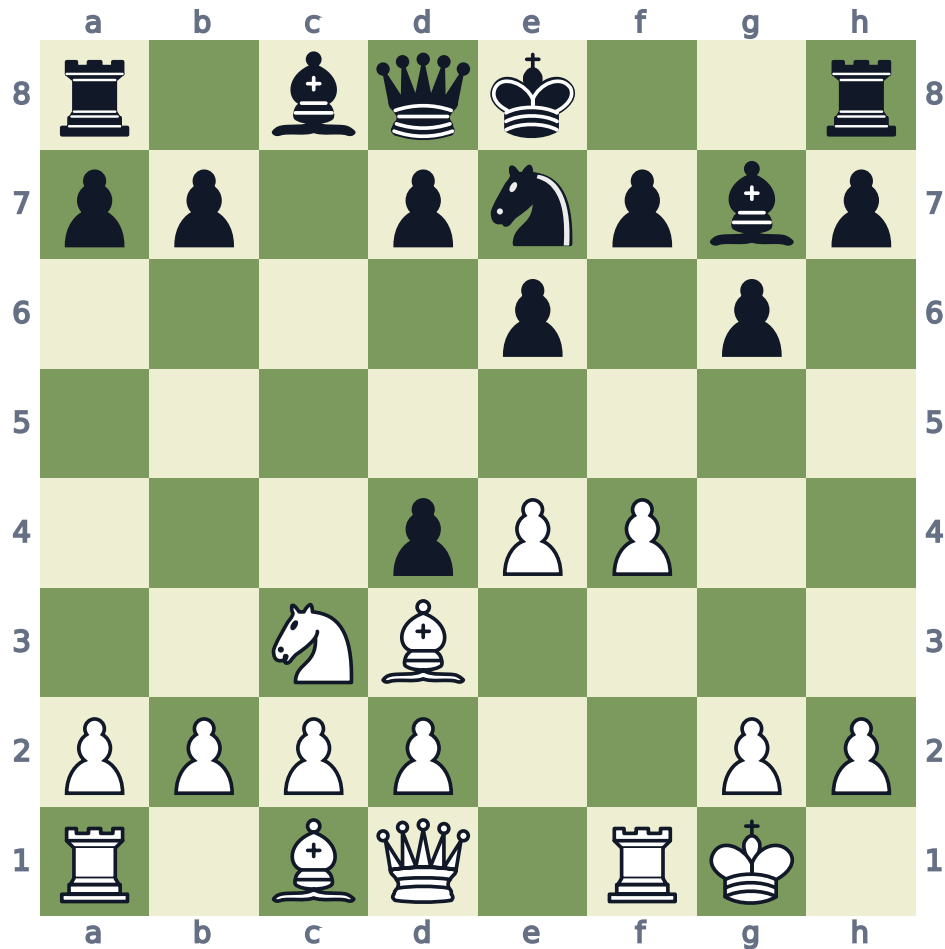
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 23 OF 30

Technical style: Grand Prix Attack



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

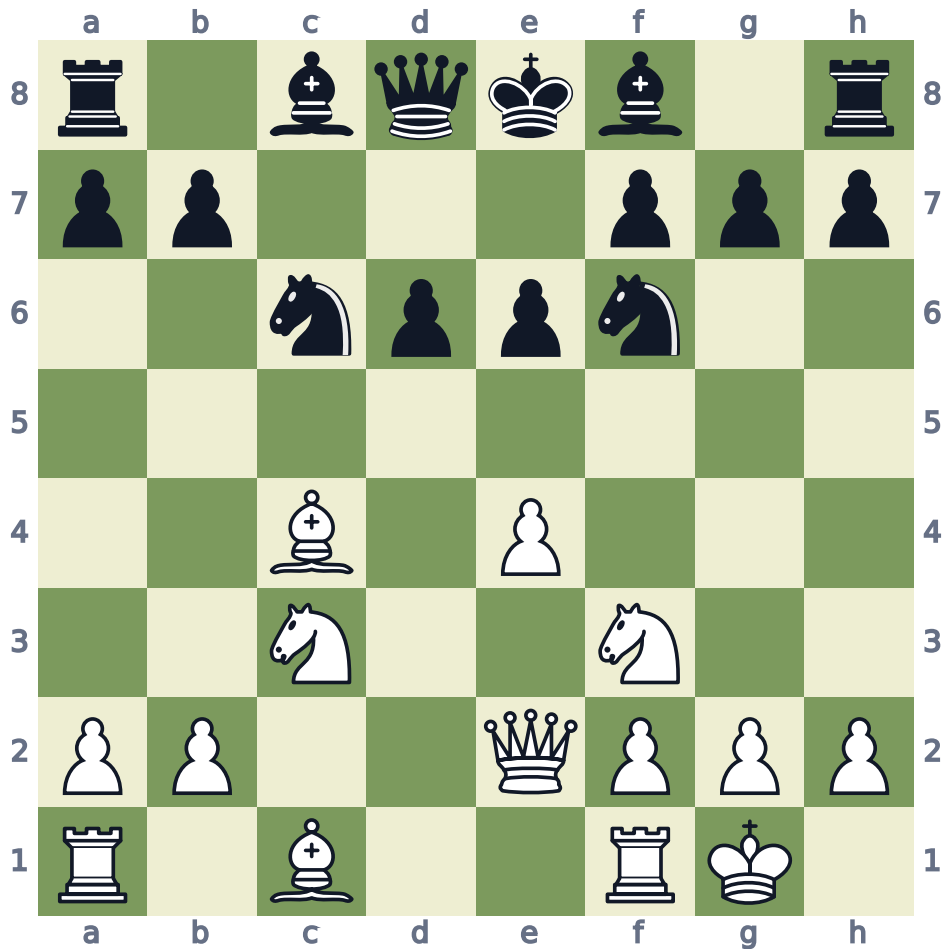
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 24 OF 30

Technical style: Smith-Morra Gambit



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a technical lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

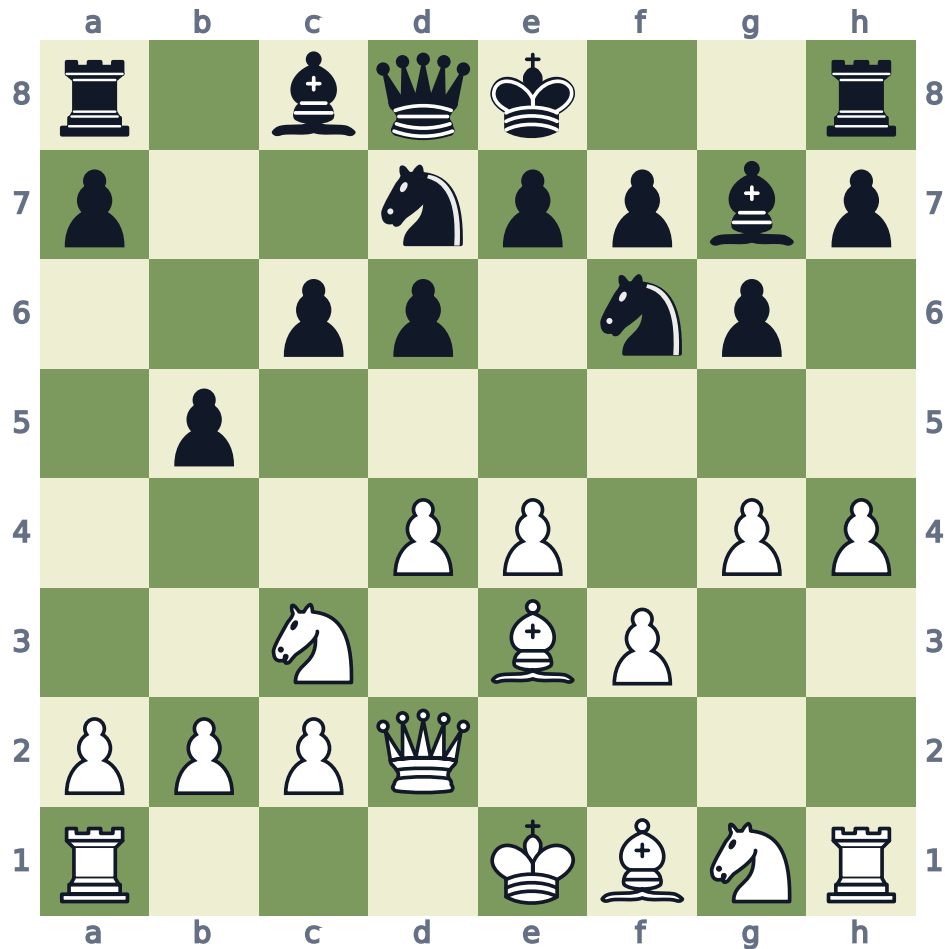
Technical decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 25 OF 30

Universal style: Pirc Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

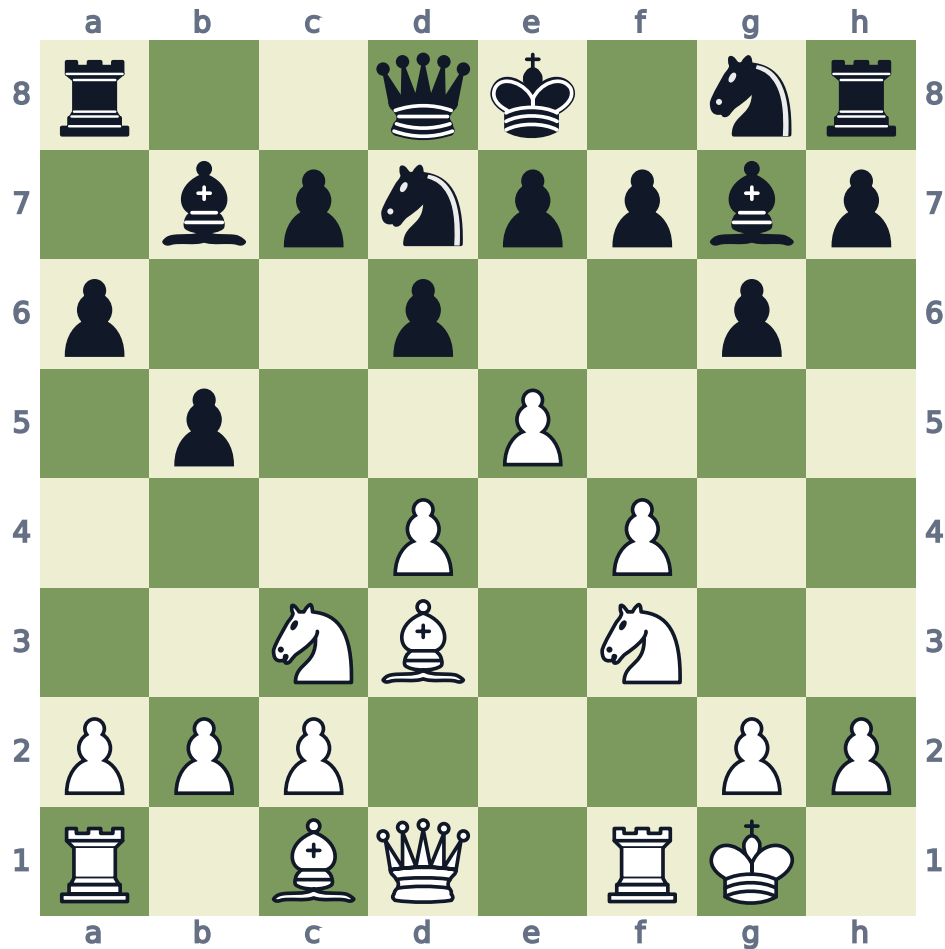
Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 26 OF 30

Universal style: Modern Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

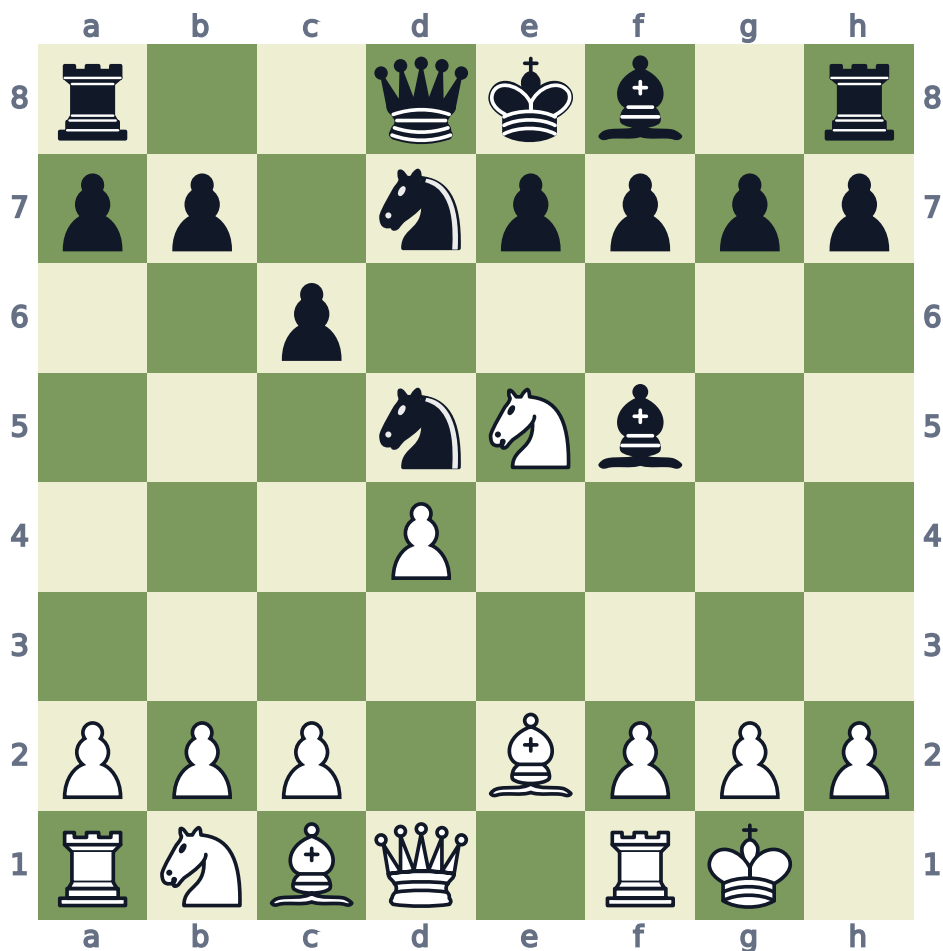
Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 27 OF 30

Universal style: Alekhine Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

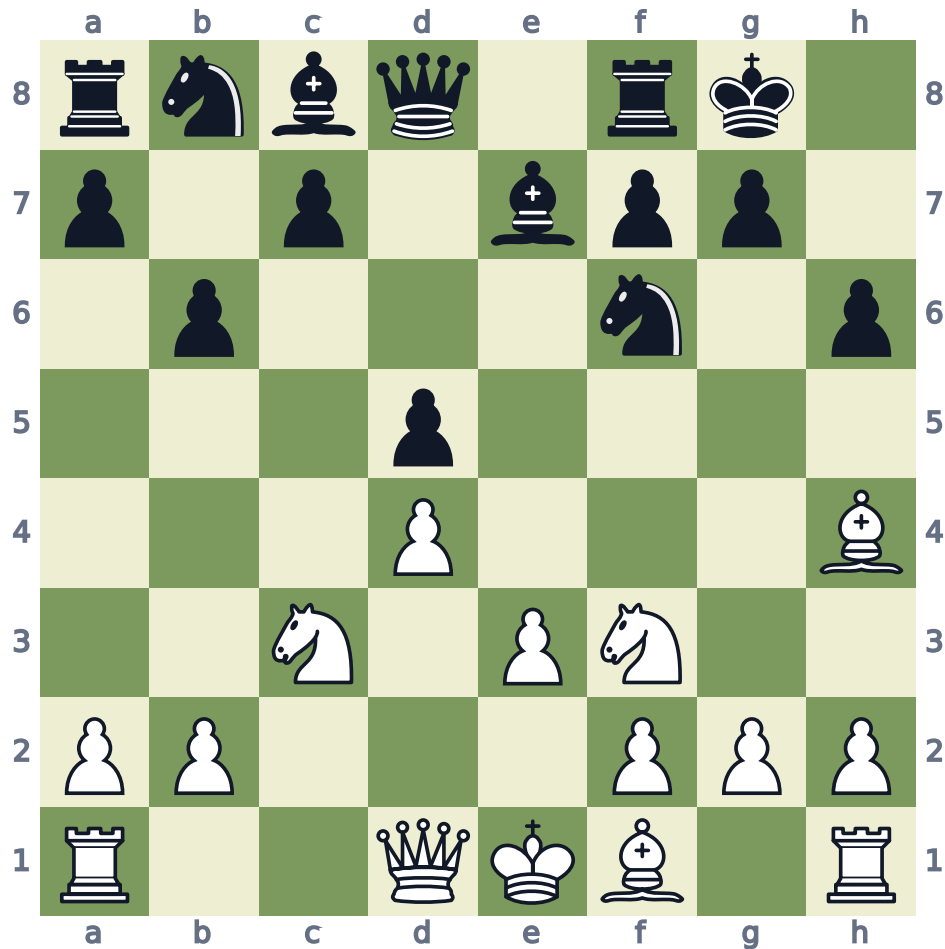
Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 28 OF 30

Universal style: Queen's Gambit



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

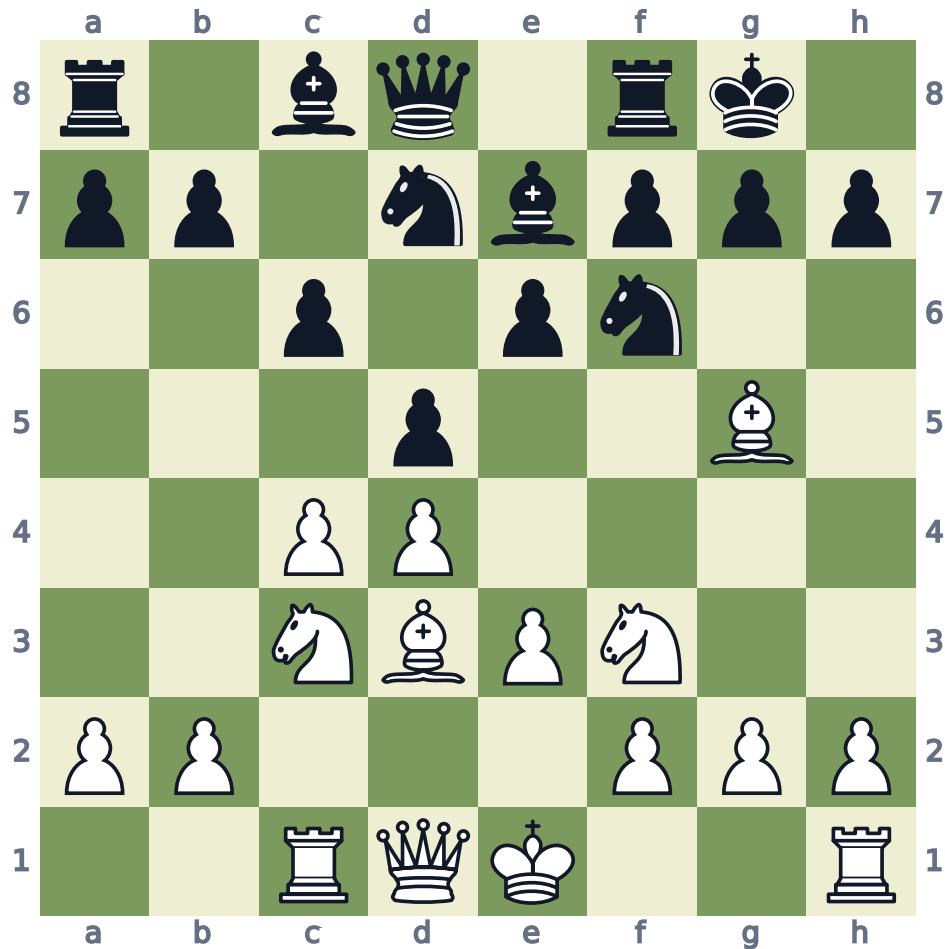
Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 29 OF 30

Universal style: Queen's Gambit Declined



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

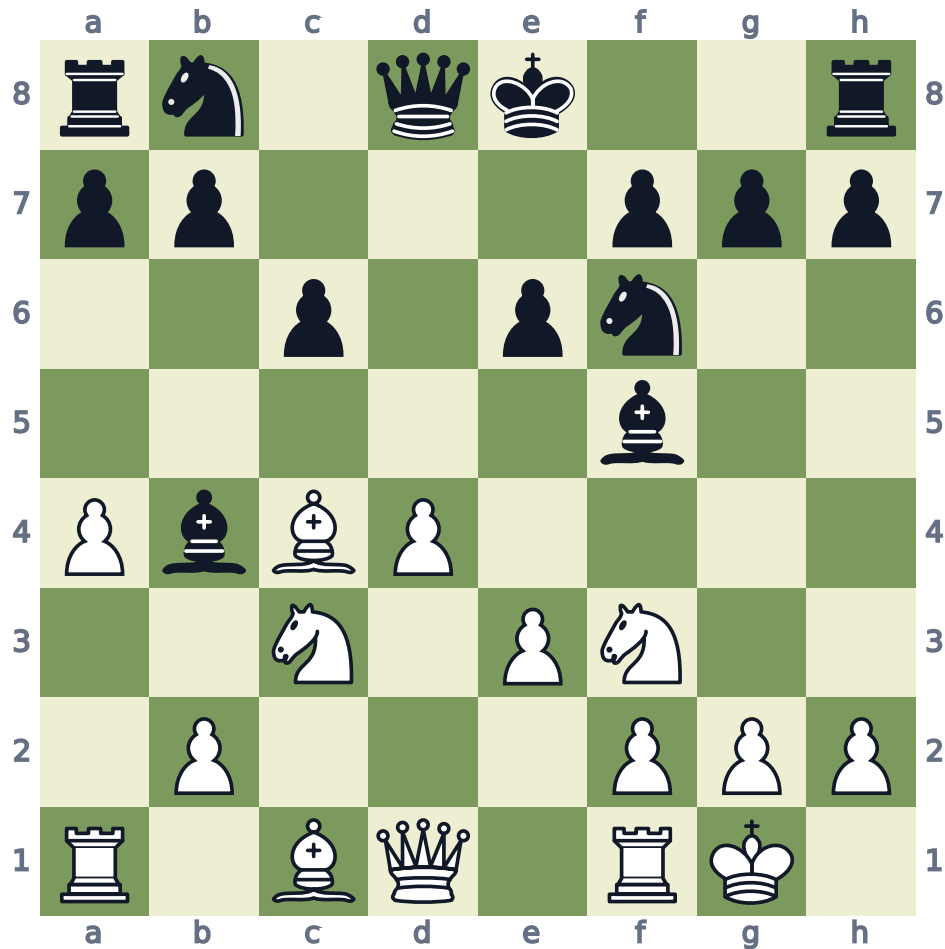
Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

PROBLEM 30 OF 30

Universal style: Slav Defense



YOUR TASK

Solve this position through a universal lens. Choose a move that is objectively sound, explain the plan, and name the danger of forcing the style onto the wrong position.

DIFFICULTY

Universal decision

BEFORE TURNING TO THE SOLUTION SECTION

Record candidates, the best defensive reply, and your final evaluation. A correct first move without a verified line earns only partial credit.

ANSWER SECTION

Solutions begin on the next page

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not browse the solution pages casually. Return to each problem, reconstruct the position, and compare the entire decision process. If your move matches but your line omits the best defense, score it as incomplete.

ERROR LABELS

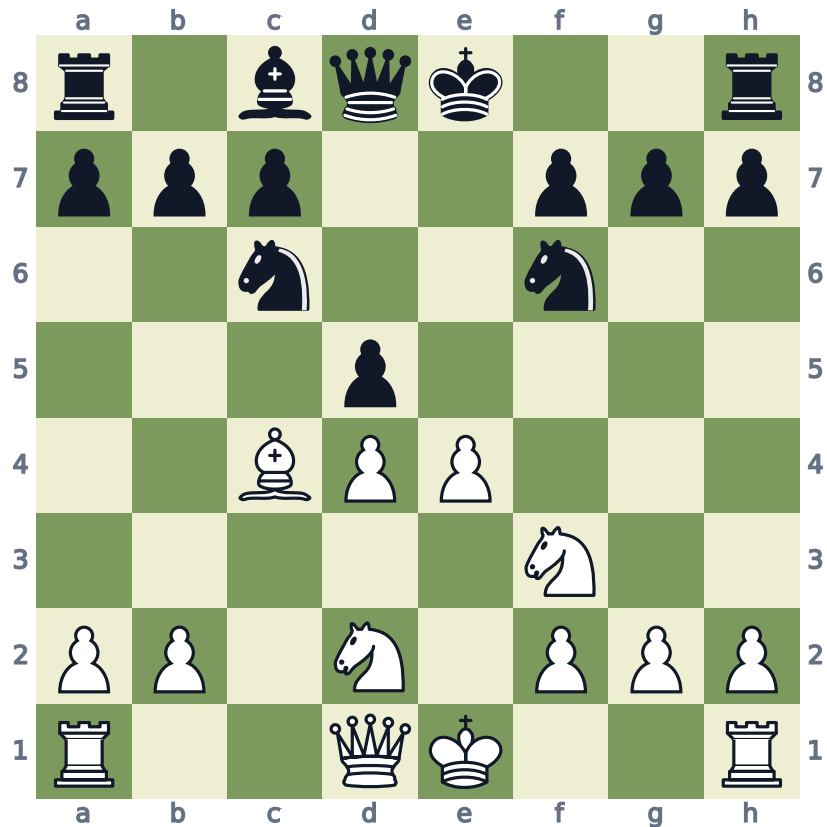
R = recognition error | C = candidate error | V = visualization error | D = missed defense | E = endpoint evaluation error | T = time-management error

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce one replacement question. Example: 'Before I calculate my attack, what countercheck does the opponent have?' Use that question in the next five slow games.

SOLUTION 01 OF 30

Attacking style: Italian Game



VERIFIED LINE

1. exd5 Nxd5 2. Qb3 Na5 3. Qa4+ Nc6

WHY IT WORKS

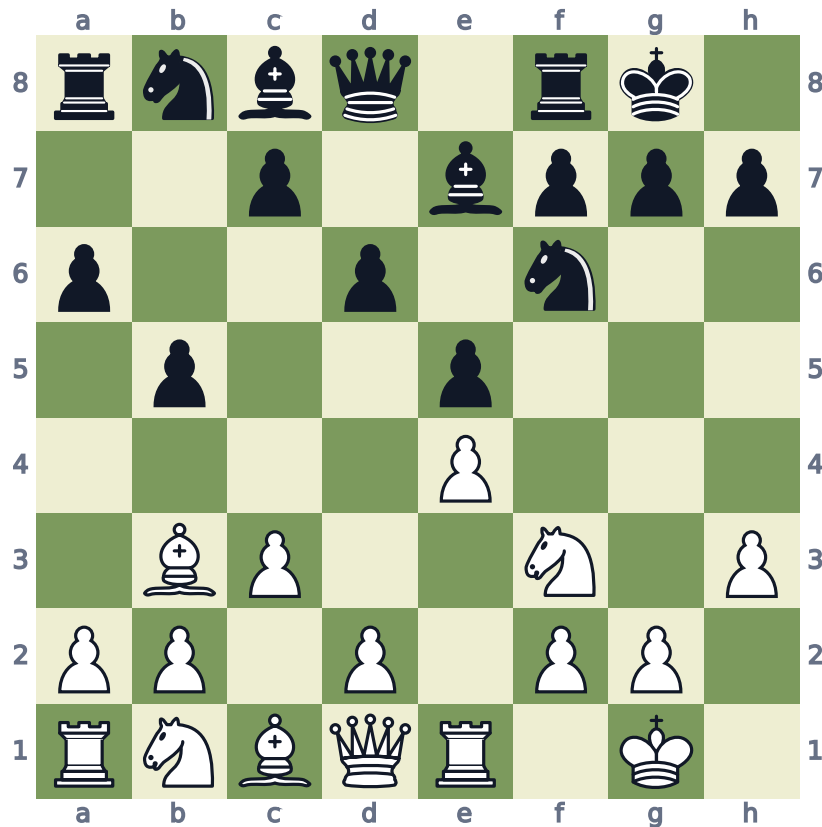
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: Develop, build d4, castle, then attack. White plan: Build d4, castle, connect the rooks, and use e5 or d5 when the center allows it. Black plan: Meet d4 in the center, finish development, and avoid passive defense around f7.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.00 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 02 OF 30

Attacking style: Ruy Lopez



VERIFIED LINE

1. a4 Bb7 2. axb5 axb5 3. Rxa8 Bxa8 4. d3 c5 5. Na3 Bc6

WHY IT WORKS

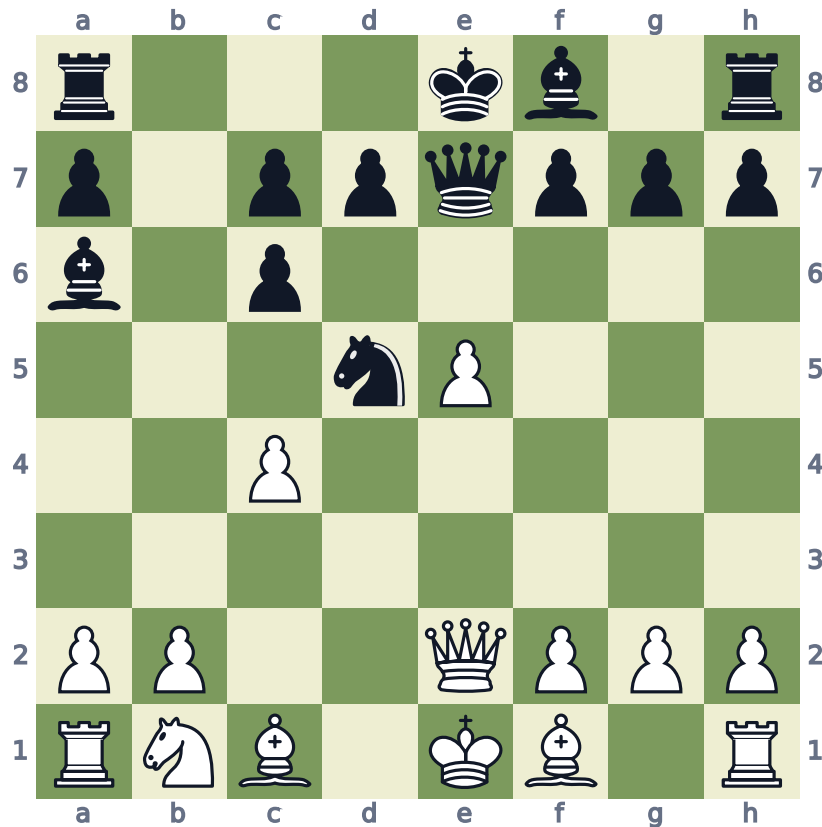
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: Pressure first, center second, tactics only when ready. White plan: Prepare d4 with c3, preserve the light bishop, and improve pieces before opening the center. Black plan: Gain space with ...b5, defend e5, and reorganize the queenside knight toward d7.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.44 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 03 OF 30

Attacking style: Scotch Game



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qe4 Nb6 2. Nc3 Qe6 3. c5 Bxf1 4. cxb6 Bc4 5. bxc7 d5

WHY IT WORKS

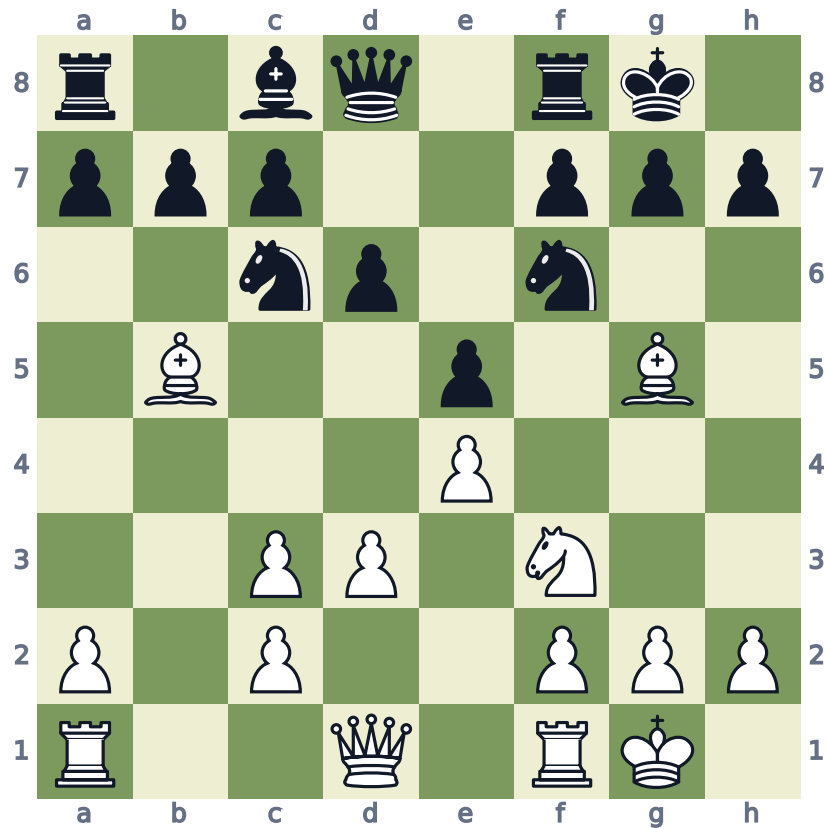
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: Open center means every tempo matters. White plan: Use the space from e5, develop rapidly, and target the altered queenside pawns. Black plan: Challenge e5, use open files and the bishop pair, and avoid falling behind in development.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.10 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 04 OF 30

Attacking style: Four Knights Game



VERIFIED LINE

1. a6 Bxc6 2. bxc6 Nd2 3. h6 Bh4 4. Qe7

WHY IT WORKS

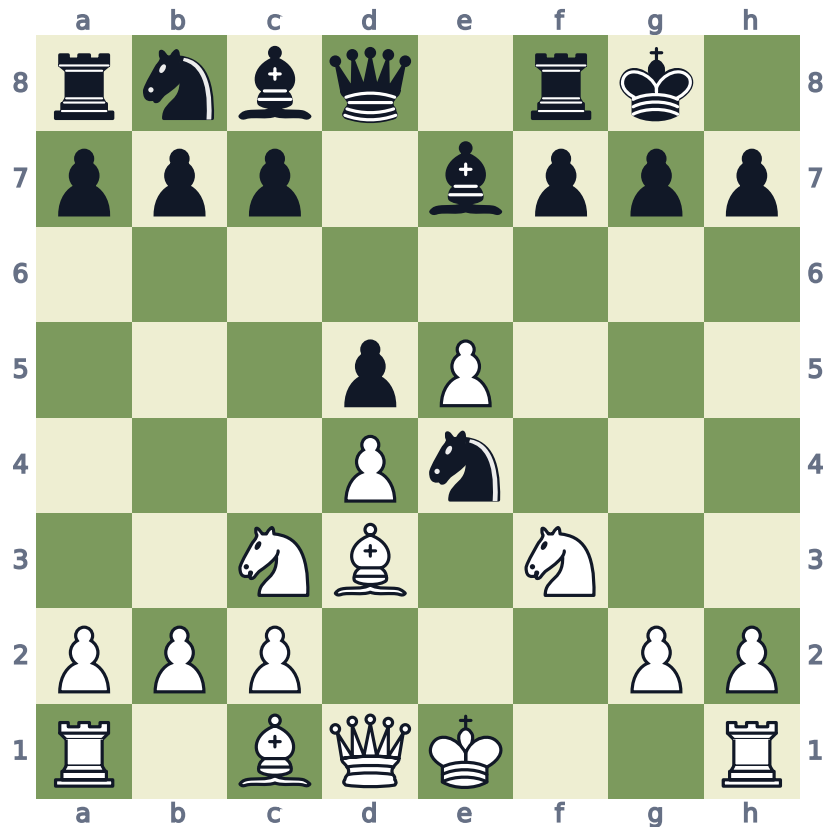
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: Complete development, then break symmetry. White plan: Castle, choose d4 or a kingside buildup, and use the bishop pin to shape the center. Black plan: Match development, decide when to exchange on c3, and strike with ...d5 when possible.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.14 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 05 OF 30

Attacking style: Vienna Game



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nxc3 bxc3 2. c5 Rb1 3. Nc6 O-O 4. c4

WHY IT WORKS

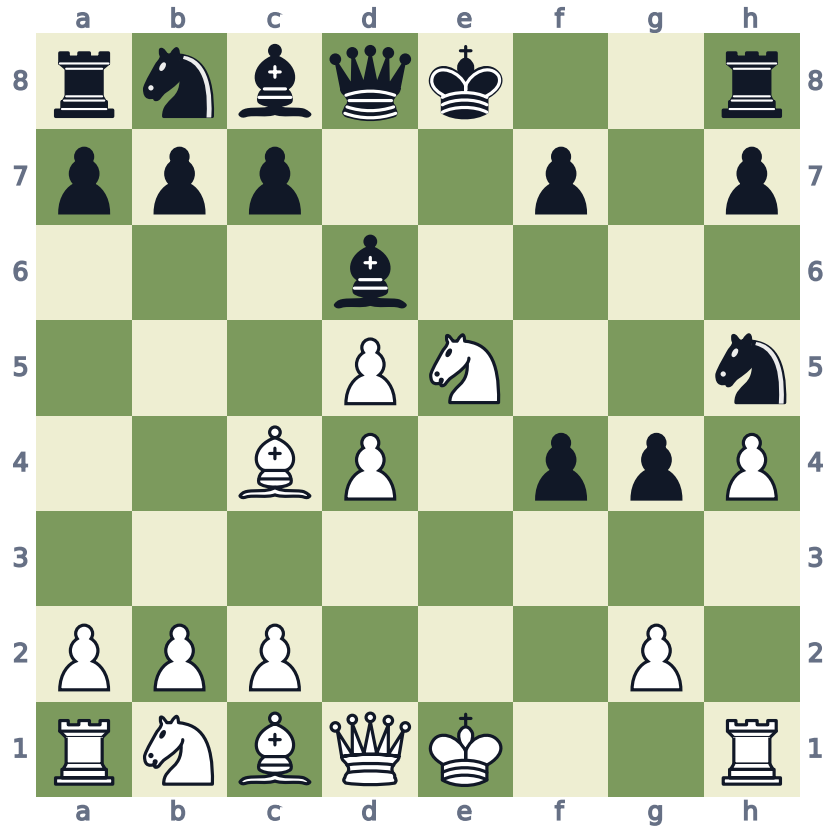
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: Flank pressure works because the center is supported. White plan: Support e4, use f4 to challenge e5, and open lines only with pieces ready. Black plan: Counter in the center with ...d5 and make White prove the kingside expansion is safe.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.18 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 06 OF 30

Attacking style: King's Gambit



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nc3 O-O 2. Ne2 f6 3. Nd3 Qe8 4. O-O b5 5. Bb3 f3

WHY IT WORKS

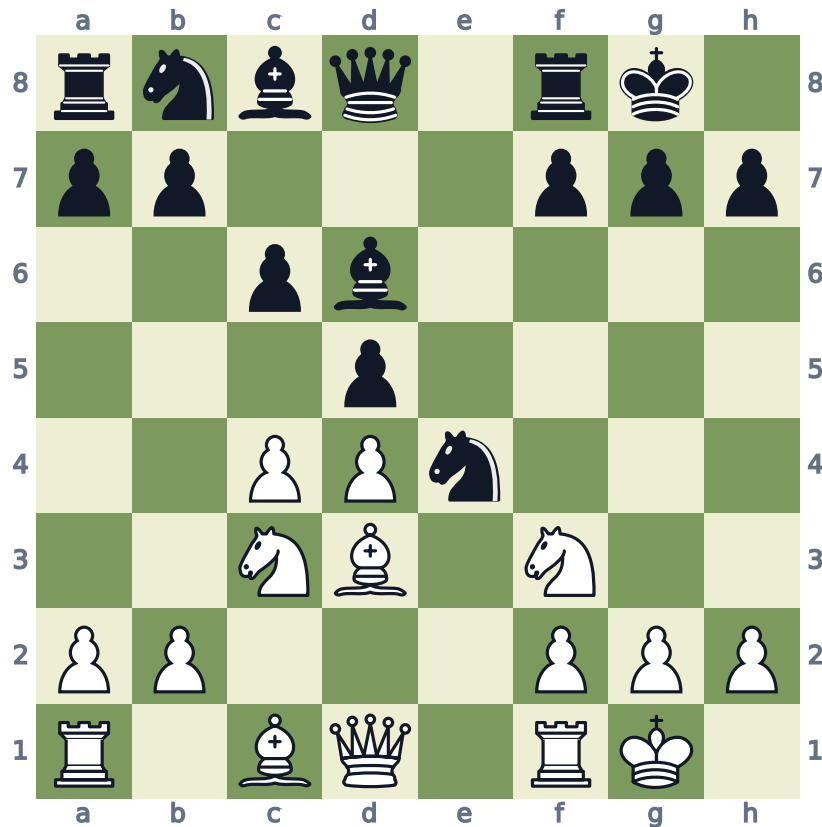
Style method: Create justified threats, increase force in the king zone, and calculate the defender's most active resource. Warning: Do not sacrifice merely because the position looks exciting. Position cue: The pawn is an investment in time, not a debt. White plan: Develop with tempo, recover control of the center, and open files toward the black king. Black plan: Keep the extra pawn only when safe, counter in the center, and return material to finish development.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -1.01 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 07 OF 30

Positional style: Petrov Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nxc3 bxc3 2. dxc4 Bxc4 3. Bg4 h3 4. Bh5 g4 5. Bg6 Ne5

WHY IT WORKS

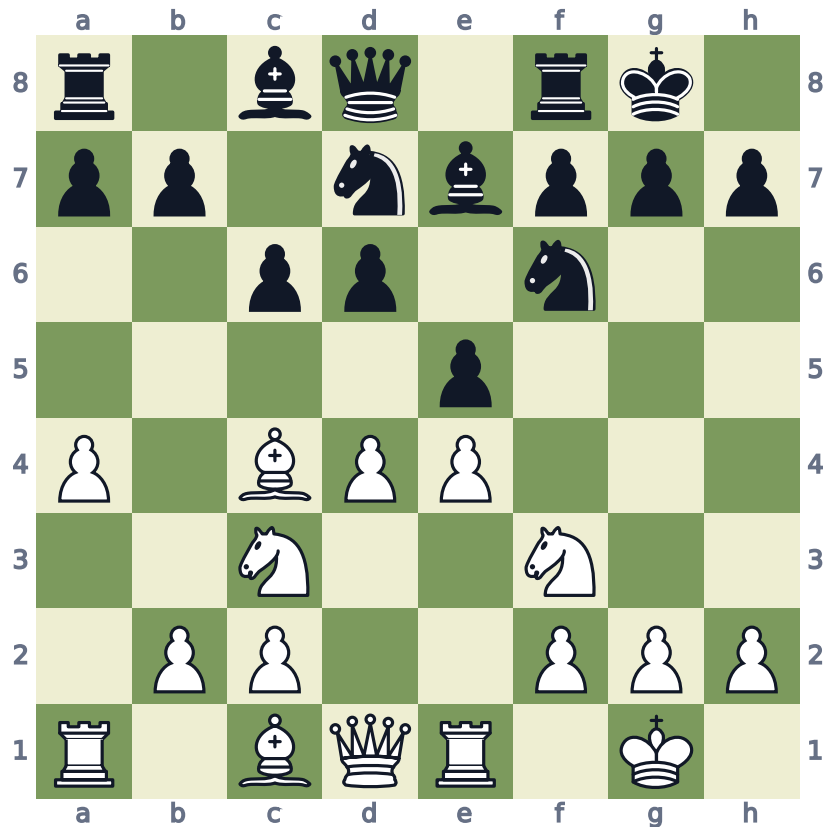
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: Challenge, chase, recover - in that order. White plan: Use the lead in space, challenge the e4-knight, and create an isolated-pawn or open-center target. Black plan: Return the pawn correctly, centralize, and use the symmetrical structure without drifting.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.49 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 08 OF 30

Positional style: Philidor Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. h6 h3 2. Re8 d5 3. Nb6 Bf1 4. a5 Be3 5. cxd5 exd5

WHY IT WORKS

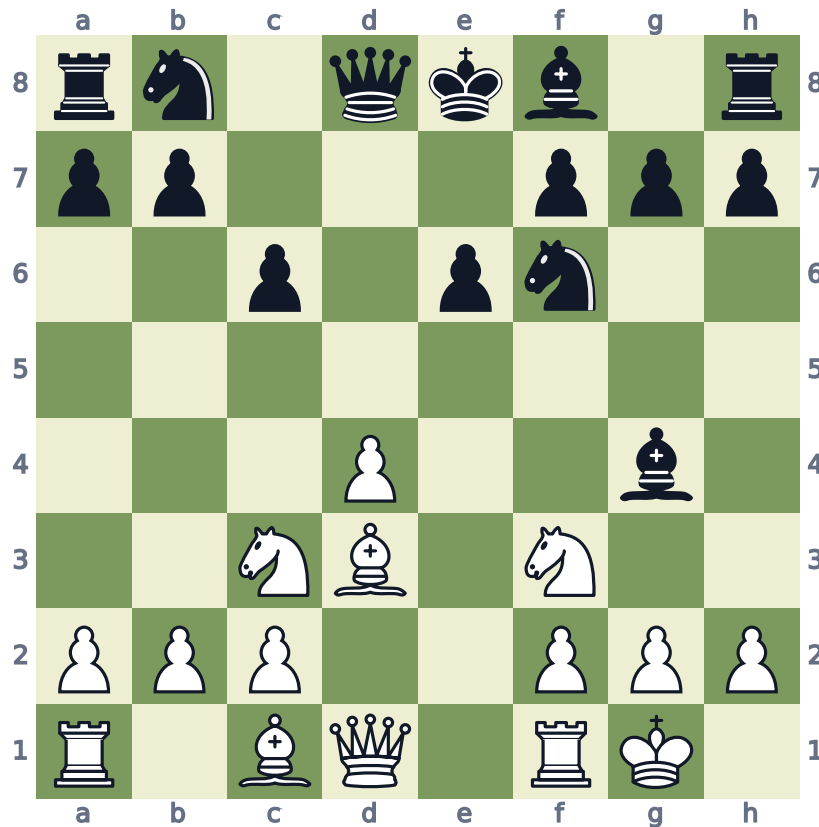
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: Solid first, free the position second. White plan: Use space, develop smoothly, and prevent Black's freeing breaks from arriving comfortably. Black plan: Finish development, support e5, and prepare ...c6 with ...Qc7 or the freeing ...d5.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.55 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 09 OF 30

Positional style: Scandinavian Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Re1 Bxf3 2. Qxf3 Qxd4 3. Ne4 Nbd7 4. Bf4 Nxe4 5. Bxe4 Qf6

WHY IT WORKS

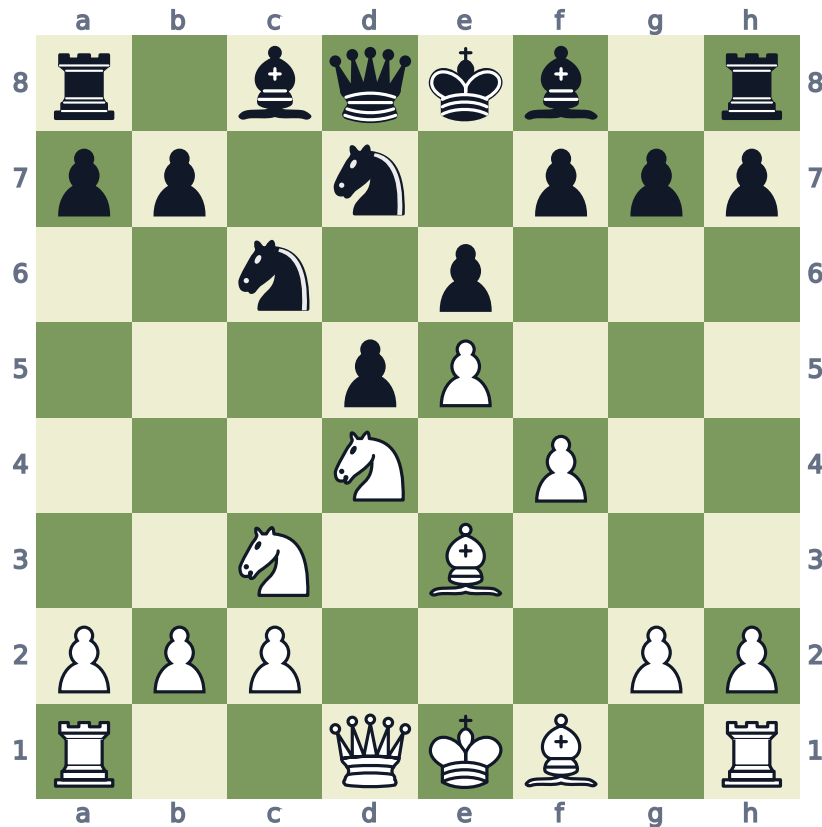
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: Take the free development, not a pawn-chasing detour. White plan: Develop with tempo, occupy the center, and use the space lead before it disappears. Black plan: Place the queen safely, build a light-square structure, and finish development without more lost tempi.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.37 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 10 OF 30

Positional style: French Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bc5 Qd2 2. Nxd4 Bxd4 3. Bxd4 Qxd4 4. Qb6 Qxb6

WHY IT WORKS

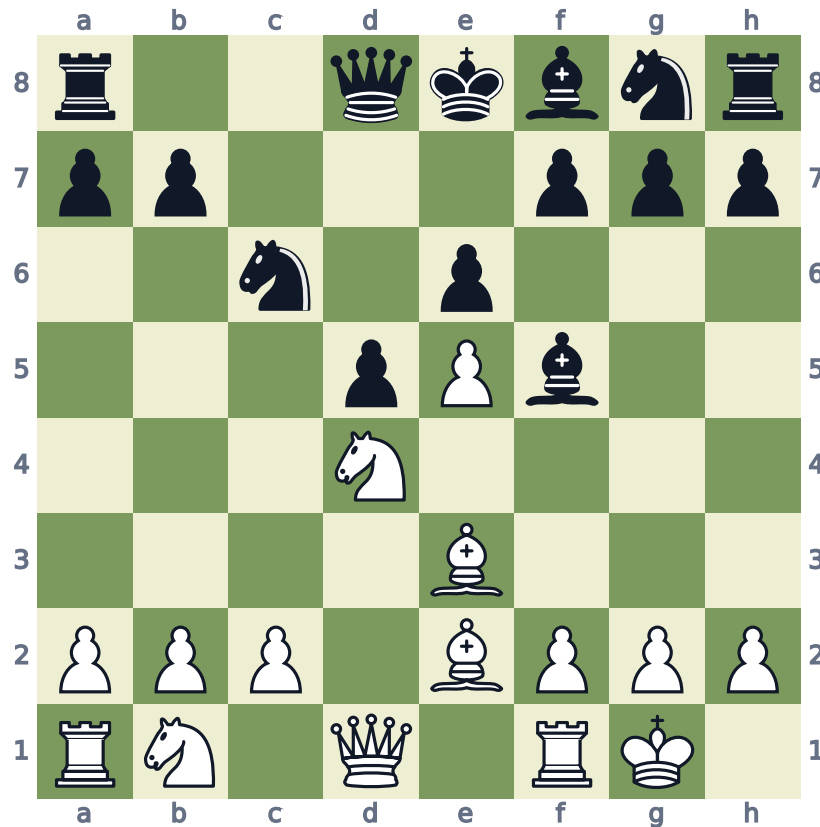
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: Pawn chains point toward the wing of attack. White plan: Support e5, develop the queenside, and attack where the pawn chain points. Black plan: Attack d4 with ...c5, challenge e5 with ...f6, and activate the c8-bishop deliberately.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.60 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 11 OF 30

Positional style: Caro-Kann Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nge7 c3 2. Nxe5 Qa4+ 3. Qd7 Bb5 4. N7c6 Nxf5 5. exf5 Bd4

WHY IT WORKS

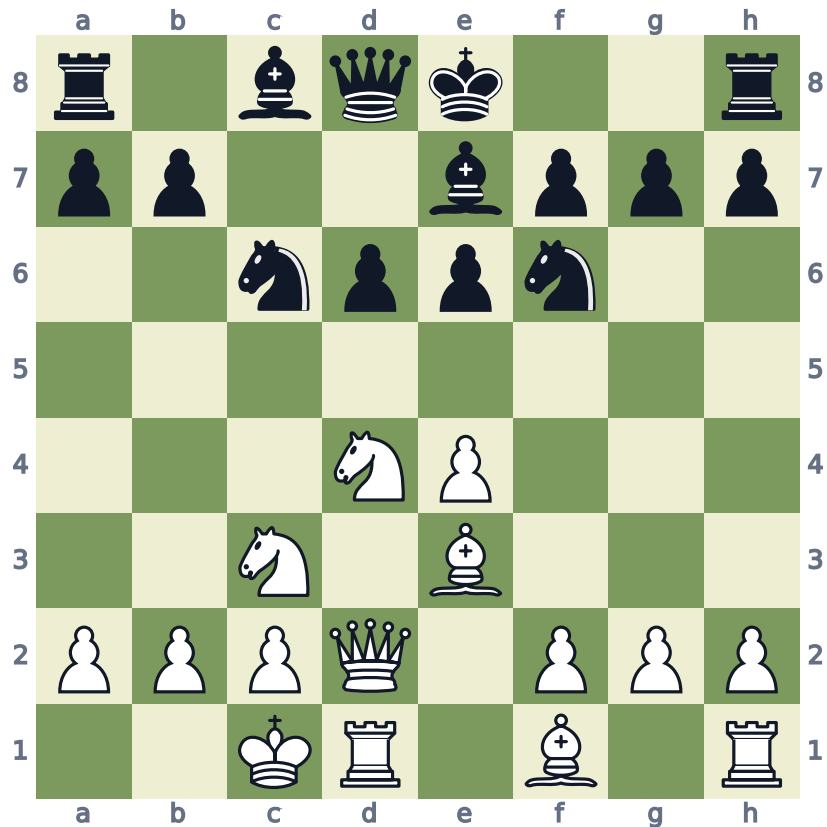
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: Bishop out, center challenged, structure sound. White plan: Use space, develop without blocking the center, and respond accurately to ...c5. Black plan: Complete development, challenge d4, and avoid allowing e5 to become untouchable.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.24 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 12 OF 30

Positional style: Open Sicilian



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ng4 Be2 2. Nxe3 Qxe3 3. Nxd4 Rxd4 4. O-O Rhd1 5. Bd7 Kb1

WHY IT WORKS

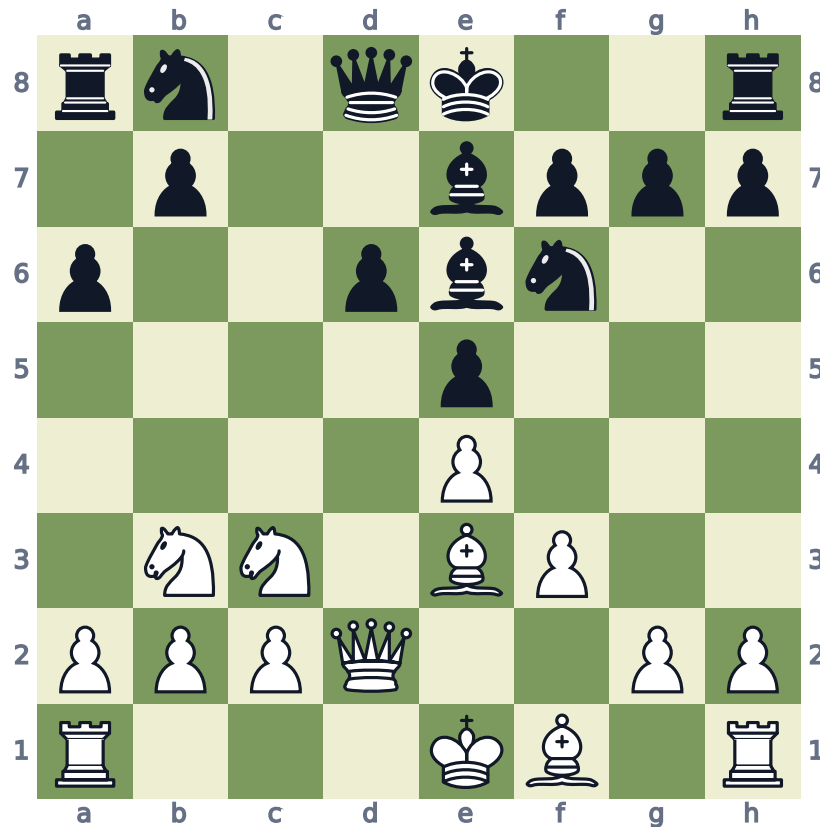
Style method: Improve pieces, restrict counterplay, and accumulate durable advantages before transforming the structure. Warning: Do not let slow improvement ignore an urgent tactical change. Position cue: White gets time; Black gets structure and counterplay. White plan: Develop quickly, use the d-file and kingside space, and decide where the king belongs. Black plan: Pressure d4, use the c-file, and counter on the queenside before White's attack lands.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.05 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 13 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Najdorf



VERIFIED LINE

1. h5 O-O-O 2. Nbd7 Nd5 3. Bxd5 exd5 4. Rc8 Qa5

WHY IT WORKS

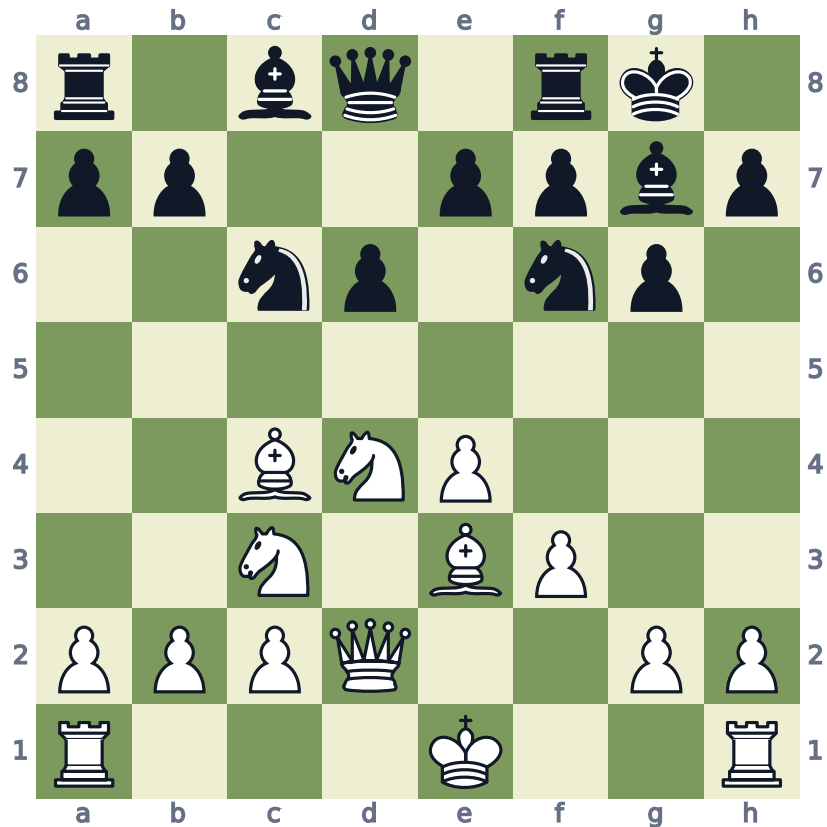
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: Control b5, expand with ...b5, fight for d5. White plan: Choose a clear setup, finish queenside development, and attack before Black completes counterplay. Black plan: Use ...b5, pressure the center, and pick ...e5 or ...e6 according to White's setup.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.28 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 14 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Dragon



VERIFIED LINE

1. Qa5 Bb3 2. Nxd4 Bxd4 3. b5 O-O-O 4. Be6 Kb1 5. b4 Nd5

WHY IT WORKS

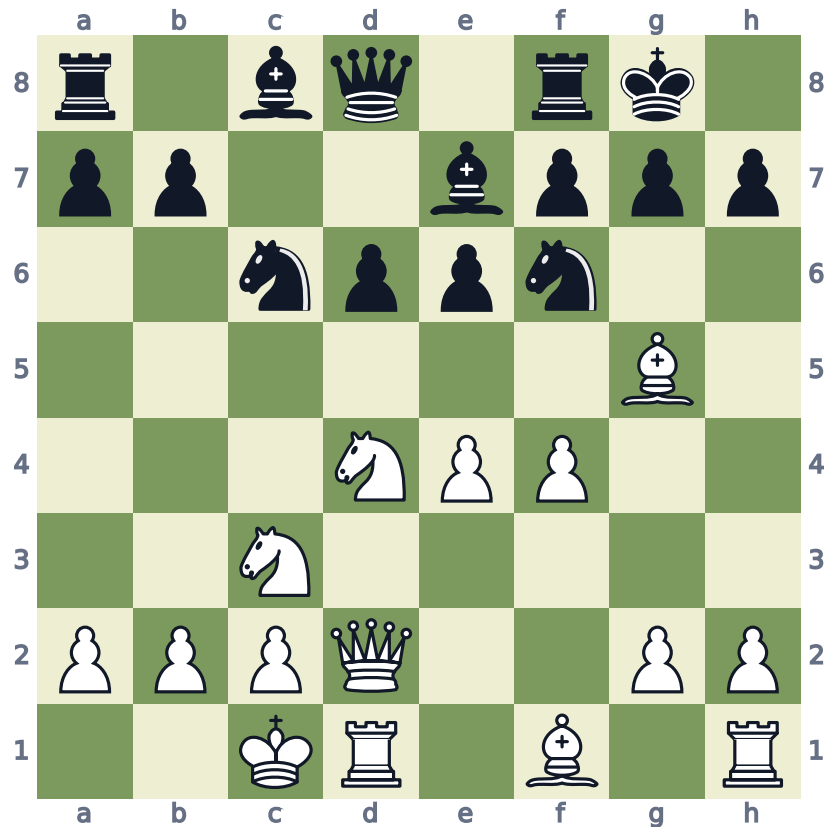
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: The g7-bishop and c-file power Black's attack. White plan: Castle long, trade the g7-bishop when useful, and push the h-pawn with full development. Black plan: Use the c-file, pressure c3, and create queenside counterplay with ...b5.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.62 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 15 OF 30

Defensive style: Classical Sicilian



VERIFIED LINE

1. h6 Bh4 2. e5 Nxc6 3. bxc6 fxe5 4. dxe5 Qxd8 5. Rxd8

WHY IT WORKS

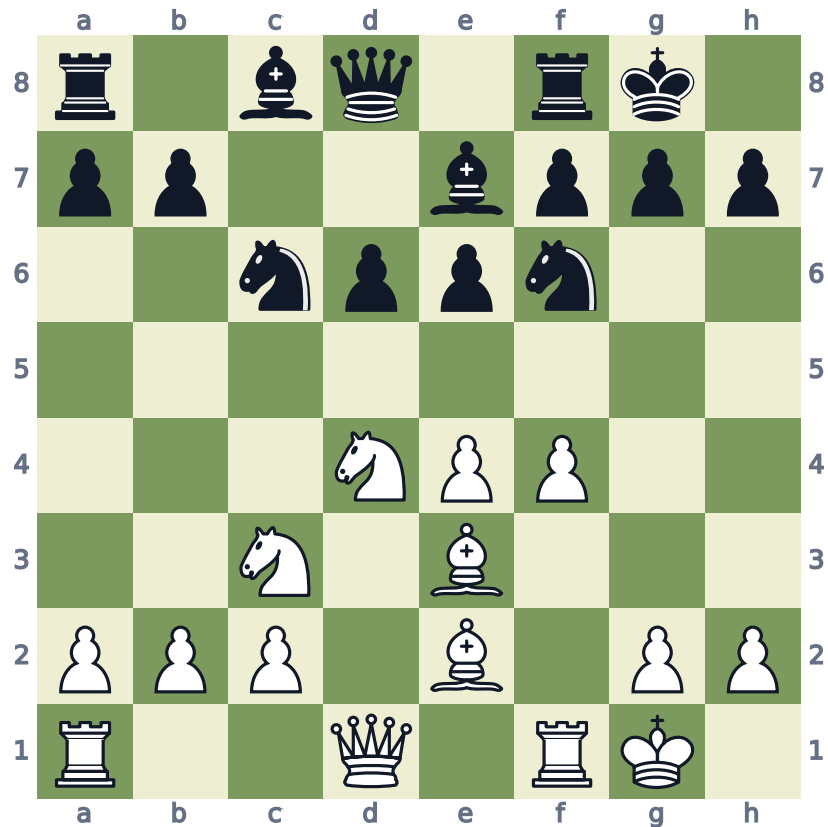
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: Natural development keeps Black's options open. White plan: Use the pin, castle long when appropriate, and build f4-f5 with piece support. Black plan: Break the pin, pressure d4, and seek ...d5 or queenside play.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.38 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 16 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Scheveningen



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bd7 Kh1 2. a6 Qd3 3. Nxd4 Bxd4 4. Bc6 Qg3 5. b5 a3

WHY IT WORKS

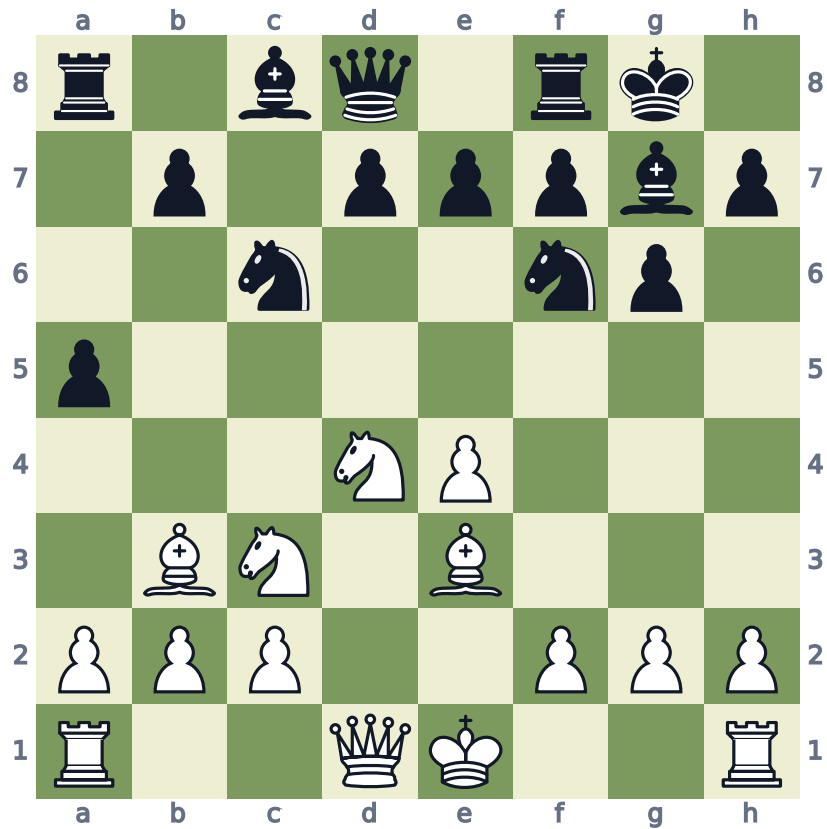
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: Compact center, flexible counterpunch. White plan: Use f4, coordinate against the king, and watch the e5-square. Black plan: Complete development, use ...Qc7 and ...b5, and time ...d5 precisely.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.39 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 17 OF 30

Defensive style: Accelerated Dragon



VERIFIED LINE

1. a4 Ng4 2. Qxg4 Nxd4 3. Bxd4 Bxd4 4. Qg3 d6 5. h4 Bd7

WHY IT WORKS

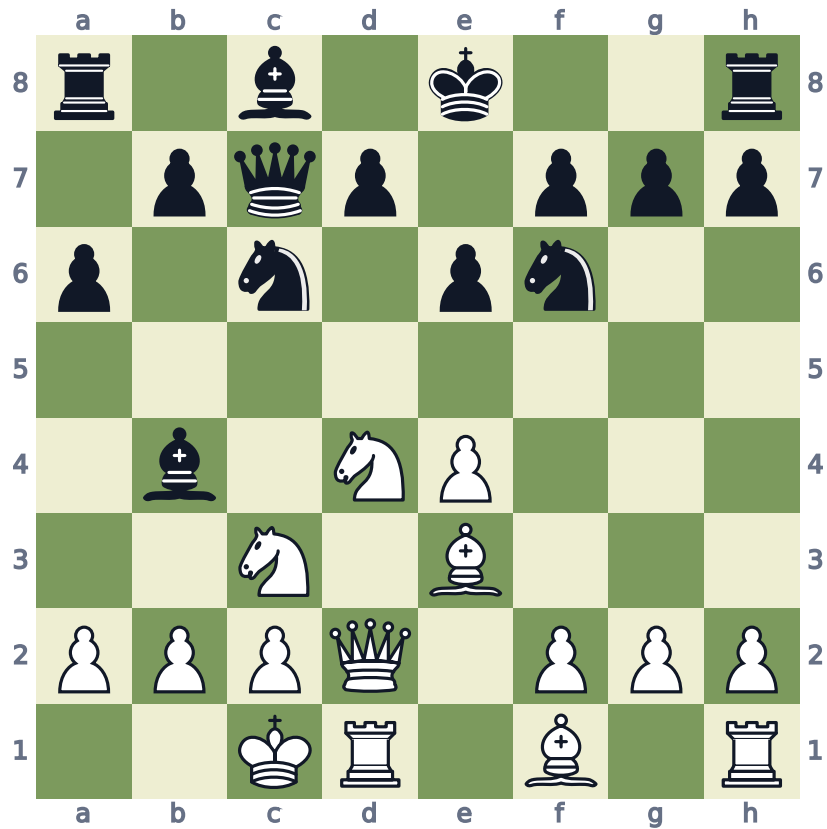
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: No ...d6 means ...d5 is always in the room. White plan: Control d5, consider the Maroczy structure with c4, and avoid routine attacking moves. Black plan: Use rapid activity, pressure d4, and strike with ...d5 when tactically sound.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.50 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 18 OF 30

Defensive style: Sicilian Taimanov



VERIFIED LINE

1. f3 d5 2. a3 Ba5 3. Nb3 Bxc3 4. Qxc3 O-O 5. Nd4 e5

WHY IT WORKS

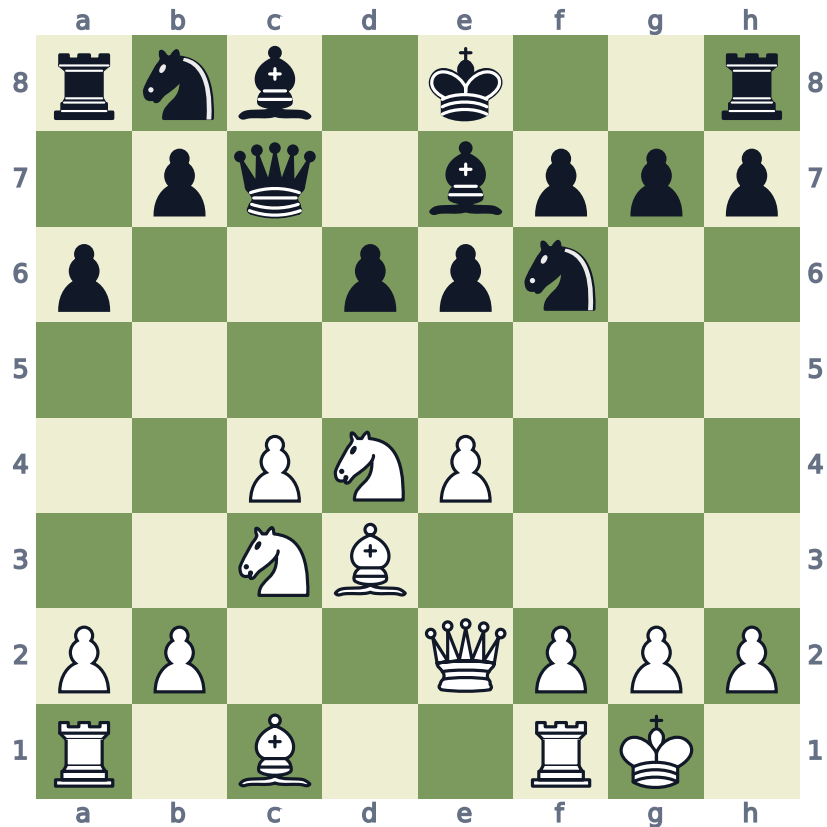
Style method: Name the threat, preserve resilience, and seek exchanges, counterchecks, or active counterplay. Warning: Do not confuse passivity with solidity. Position cue: Queen on c7 makes e5, c3, and h2 matter. White plan: Develop quickly, decide between long castling and a quieter setup, and watch ...Bb4. Black plan: Use ...a6 and ...b5, pressure c3 and e4, and prepare ...Nf6 or ...d5.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.63 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 19 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Kan



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nc6 Nxc6 2. bxc6 Be3 3. Nd7 f4 4. c5 Rf3 5. Bb7 Rg3

WHY IT WORKS

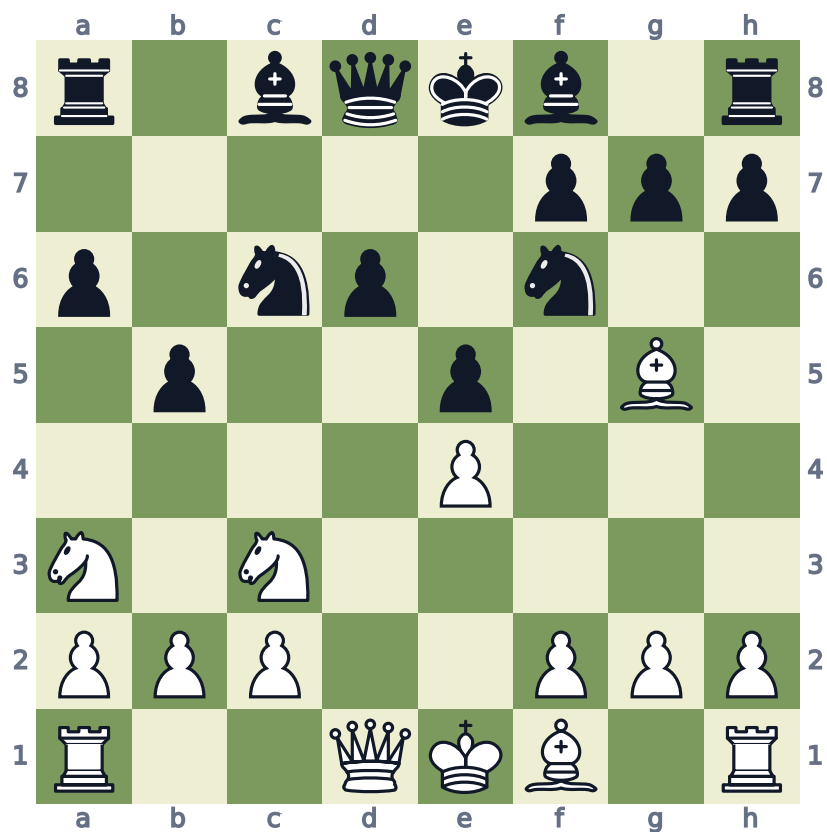
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Delay the knight, keep every structure available. White plan: Claim space with c4 when useful, finish development, and prevent an easy ...d5. Black plan: Use ...b5, choose the best square for the b8-knight, and challenge White's space later.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.63 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 20 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Sveshnikov



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bxf6 gxf6 2. Nd5 Bg7 3. c3 f5 4. Bd3 Ne7 5. Nxe7 Qxe7

WHY IT WORKS

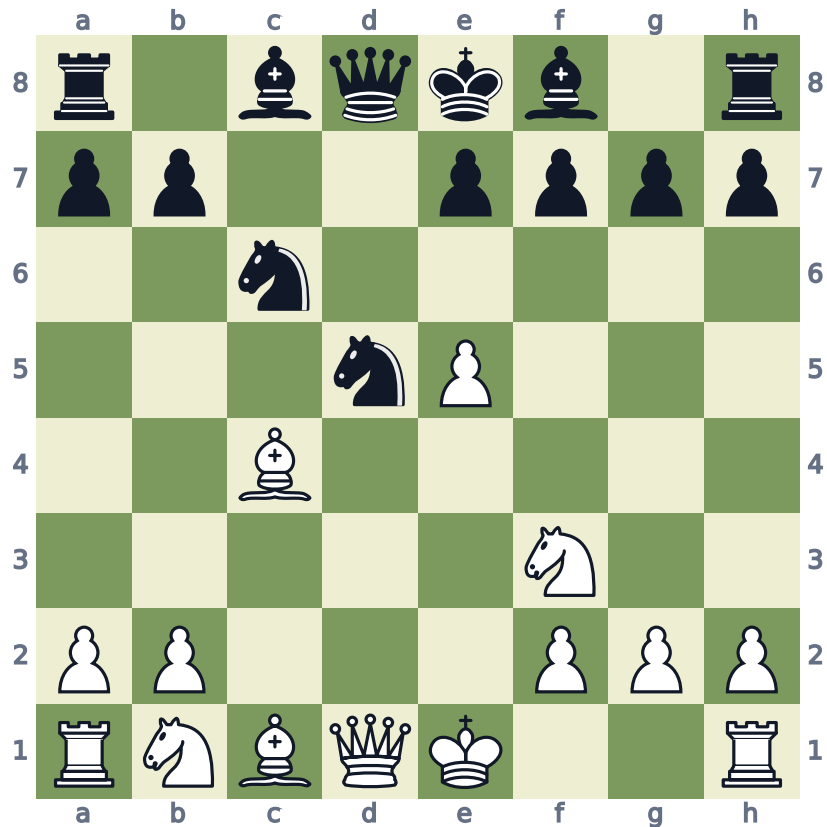
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Static weaknesses are the price of dynamic time. White plan: Use d5 as an outpost, pressure d6, and stop Black's active pawn expansion. Black plan: Gain space with ...b5 and ...f5, use active pieces, and avoid passive defense of weaknesses.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.46 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 21 OF 30

Technical style: Sicilian Alapin



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nb6 Qxd8+ 2. Nxd8 Bb5+ 3. Bd7 Nc3 4. Bxb5 Nxb5

WHY IT WORKS

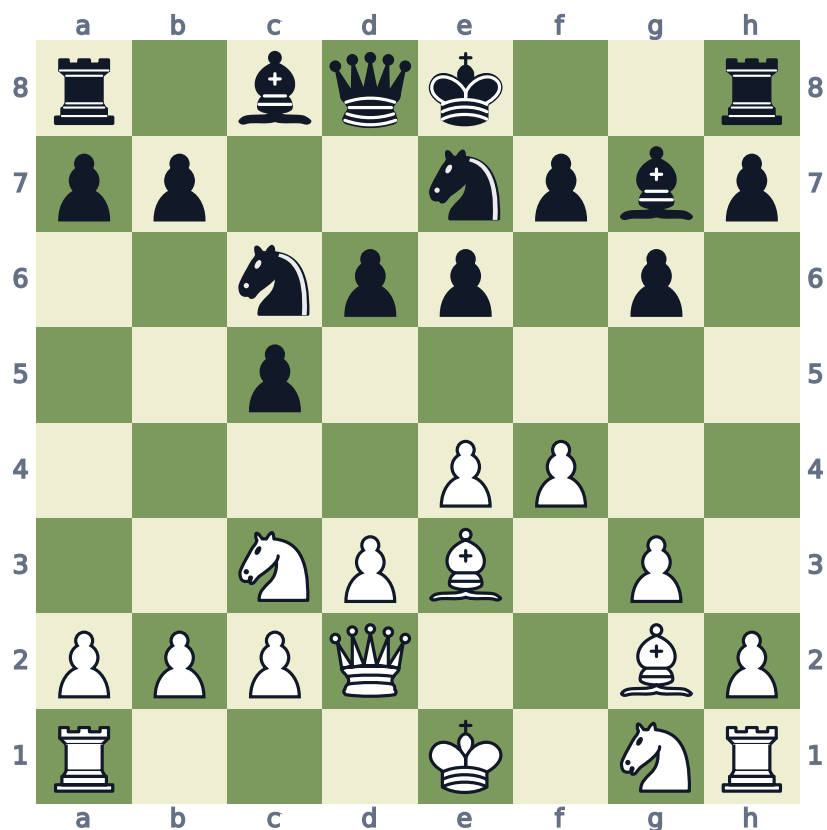
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Build d4, then defend the center with pieces. White plan: Build the center, develop behind it, and use space without overprotecting every pawn. Black plan: Attack e4 immediately, exchange central pawns, and make White prove the center is stable.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.12 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 22 OF 30

Technical style: Closed Sicilian



VERIFIED LINE

1. Rb8 Nf3 2. b5 e5 3. Nf5 Ne4 4. O-O Bf2 5. dxe5

WHY IT WORKS

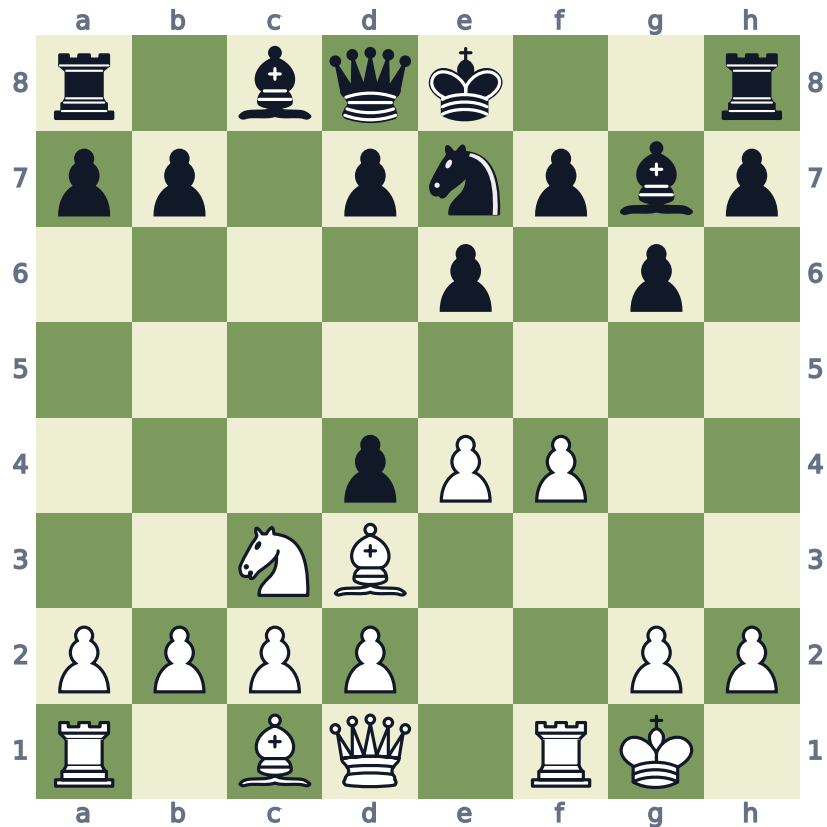
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Closed center buys time - use it to finish the setup. White plan: Fianchetto, castle, use f4-f5, and keep queenside counterplay under observation. Black plan: Expand with ...Rb8 and ...b5, challenge d4 or e5, and avoid waiting passively.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.29 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 23 OF 30

Technical style: Grand Prix Attack



VERIFIED LINE

1. Ne2 Nc6 2. c3 O-O 3. Kh1

WHY IT WORKS

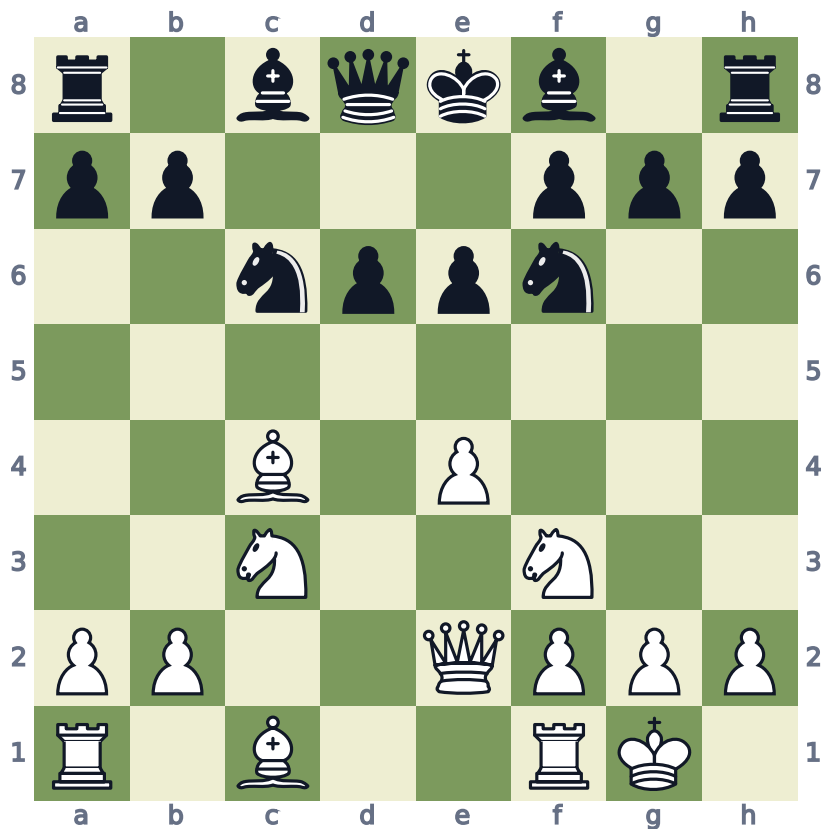
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Castle first, aim at h7, calculate ...d5. White plan: Castle, place the queen toward e1-h4, and use f5 only when pieces support it. Black plan: Counter in the center, use ...d5, and make the b5-bishop decide its future.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.05 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 24 OF 30

Technical style: Smith-Morra Gambit



VERIFIED LINE

1. Be7 Rd1 2. e5 h3 3. O-O b3

WHY IT WORKS

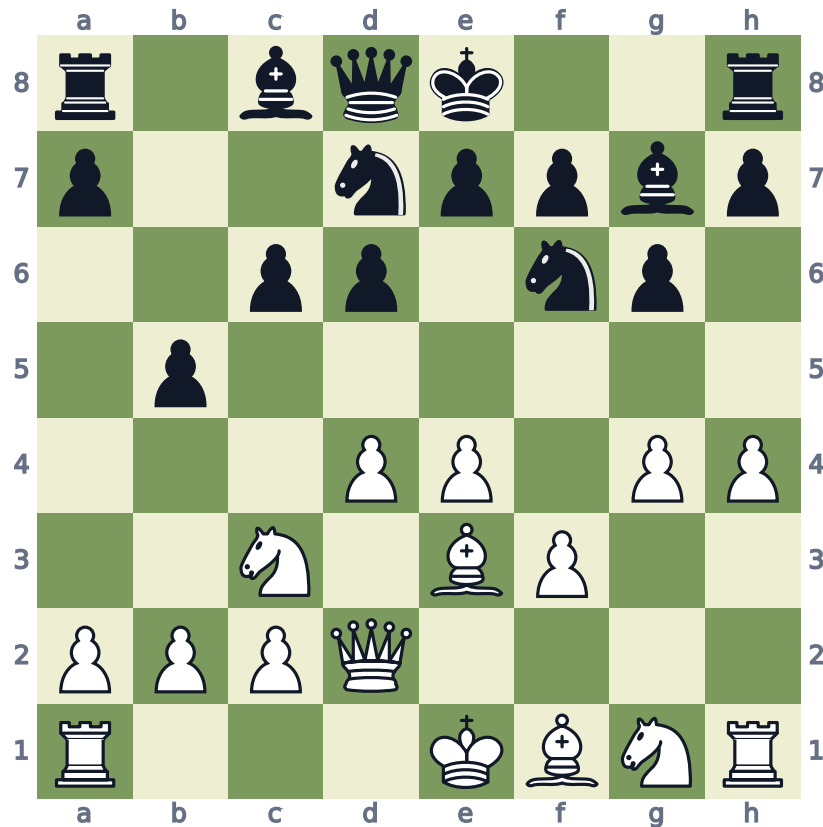
Style method: Reduce counterplay, improve the king and worst piece, and convert advantages through exact calculation. Warning: Do not simplify into an unverified ending. Position cue: Development and open files are the compensation. White plan: Put rooks on open files, develop every piece, and attack before queens are traded. Black plan: Complete development, return material if necessary, and blunt White's activity with accurate defense.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.33 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 25 OF 30

Universal style: Pirc Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. h5 g5 2. Nh7 f4 3. Nb6 b3 4. b4

WHY IT WORKS

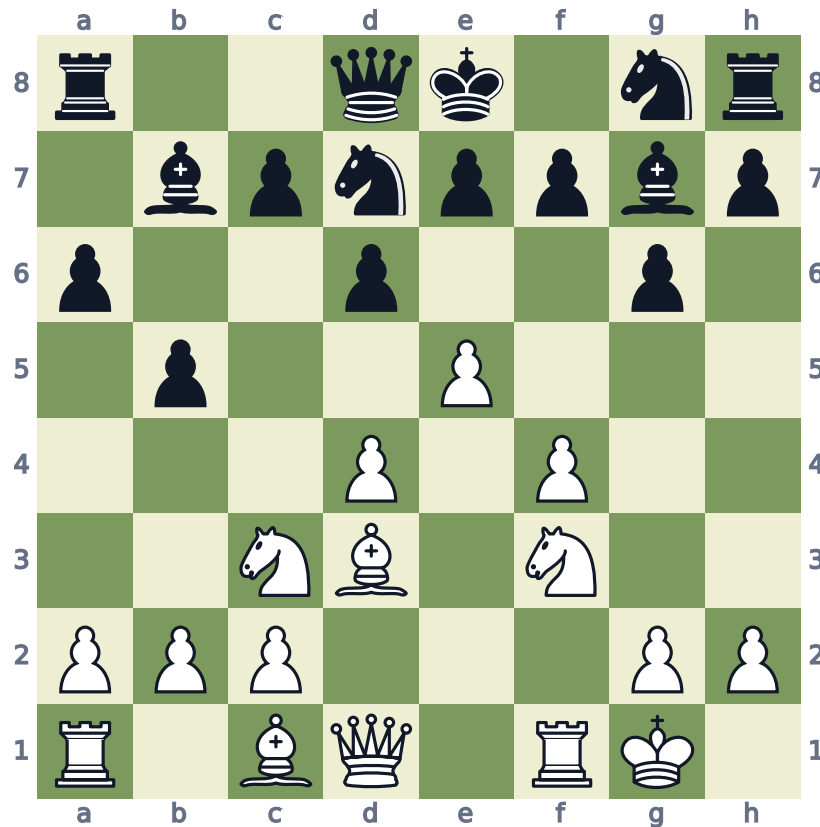
Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference. Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: Invite the center, then hit its base. White plan: Use the space responsibly, choose a setup, and avoid creating targets faster than threats. Black plan: Fianchetto, strike with ...e5 or ...c5, and create queenside play against an overextended center.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.52 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 26 OF 30

Universal style: Modern Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nh6 Ng5 2. O-O e6 3. Bxd4+ Kh1 4. Nc5 f5 5. Nxd3 Qxd3

WHY IT WORKS

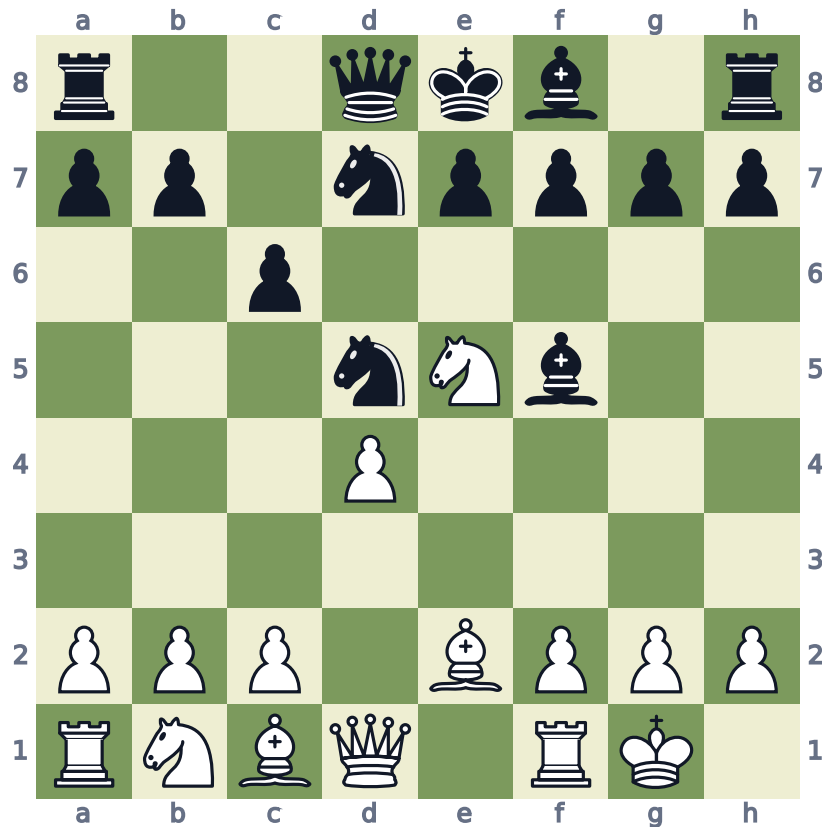
Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference. Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: Delay commitment, not development forever. White plan: Occupy the center, develop behind it, and expand only when the king is safe. Black plan: Attack the center with ...c5 or ...e5 and use queenside space without neglecting development.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.58 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 27 OF 30

Universal style: Alekhine Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. c4 Nb4 2. Nf3 e5 3. dxe5 Nc2 4. Nd4 Nxd4 5. Qxd4 Bc5

WHY IT WORKS

Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference.

Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: Space is useful only when pieces can use it. White plan: Use the space but support it with pieces, not endless pawn moves.

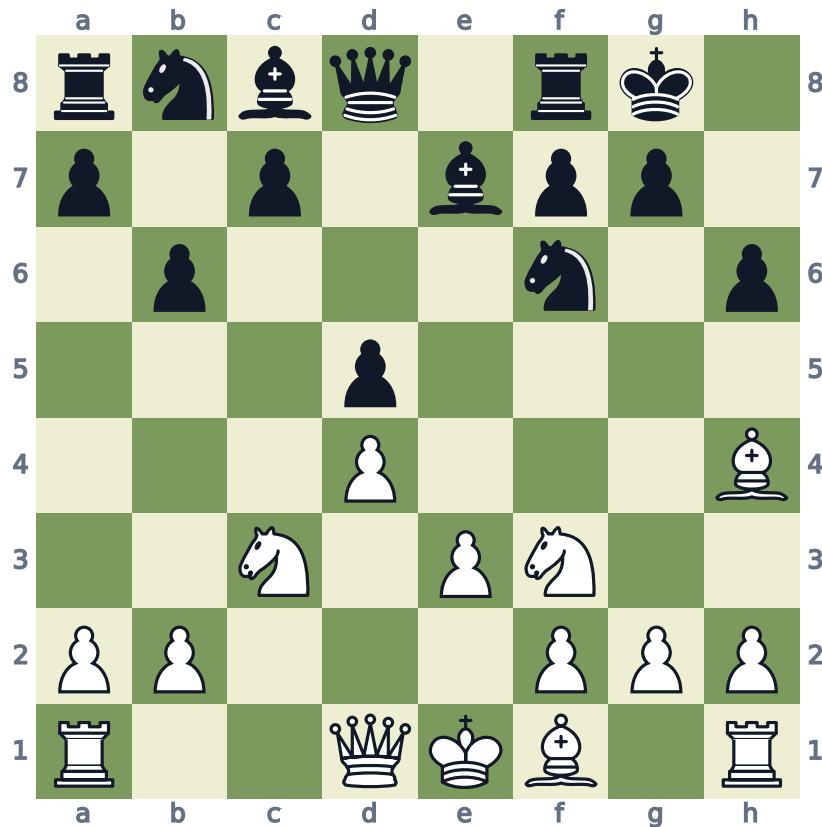
Black plan: Challenge e5 and d4, exchange central pawns, and develop without getting trapped.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.64 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 28 OF 30

Universal style: Queen's Gambit



VERIFIED LINE

1. Bd3 Bb7 2. Qc2 c5 3. O-O Nc6 4. a3 c4 5. Be2

WHY IT WORKS

Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference.

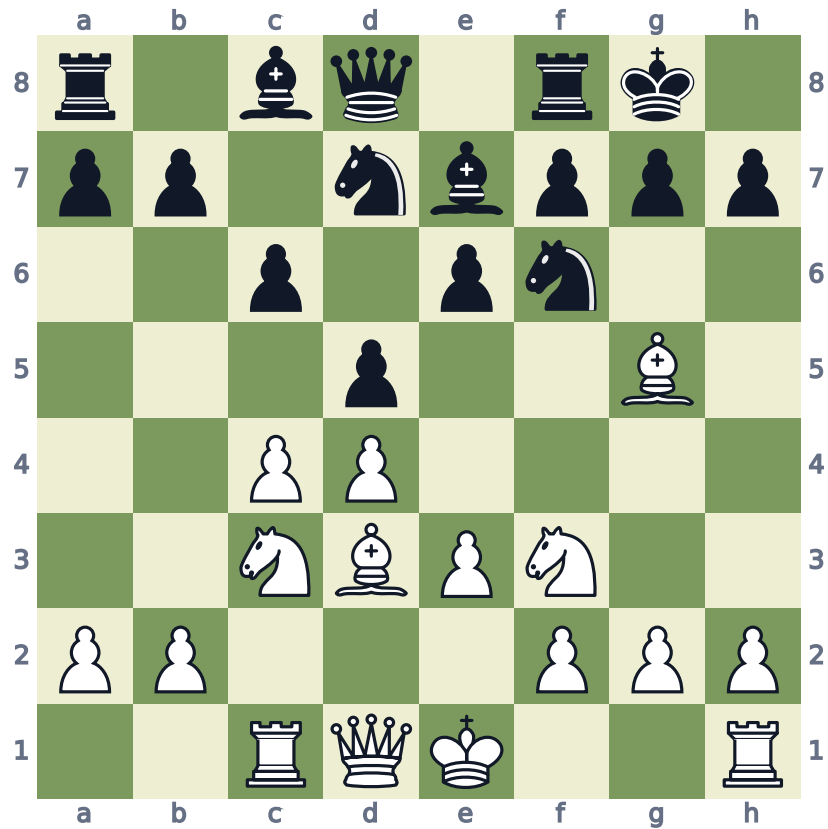
Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: The c-pawn asks Black's d-pawn a structural question. White plan: Develop, choose the right central exchange, and use queenside space or a minority attack. Black plan: Maintain or resolve the center, free the c8-bishop, and contest the c-file.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: +0.46 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 29 OF 30

Universal style: Queen's Gambit Declined



VERIFIED LINE

1. dxc4 Bxc4 2. a6 Bd3 3. c5 O-O 4. h6 Bh4

WHY IT WORKS

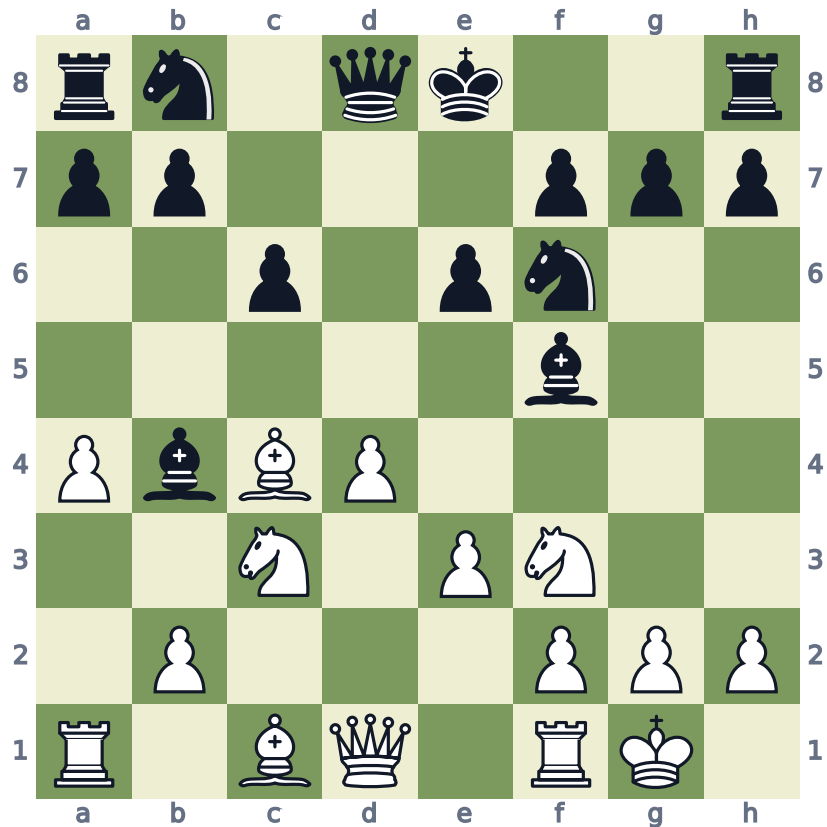
Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference. Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: Support the center, then free the bishop. White plan: Develop pressure, choose between cxd5 and a maintained tension, and use active piece placement. Black plan: Complete development, prepare ...c5 or ...e5, and solve the c8-bishop.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.25 from the side-to-move perspective.

SOLUTION 30 OF 30

Universal style: Slav Defense



VERIFIED LINE

1. Nbd7 Nh4 2. Bg6 Nxg6 3. hxg6 Qb3 4. a5 e4

WHY IT WORKS

Style method: Choose the method demanded by the position, even when it differs from your preference.

Warning: Flexibility is not aimlessness; evaluation must select the mode of play. Position cue: Support d5 without locking in the bishop. White plan: Develop, recover c4 efficiently, and use e4 when the center permits it. Black plan: Develop the bishop before ...e6, decide whether to hold c4 briefly, and challenge the center.

SCORING

2 sound move, 2 plan, 1 counterplan, 1 style limitation = 6 points Engine assessment: -0.31 from the side-to-move perspective.

REVIEW

Final mixed review

1

Select five missed positions and solve them in random order without motif names.

2

Explain why the best defense fails in each of those positions.

3

Reverse the board and describe whether the same geometry is still easy to recognize.

4

Find one example of the theme in your own game or a Fritz training game.

5

Retest under a shorter clock only after calculation is accurate without time pressure.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.